CANADIAN UNIVERSITY DUBAI
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ACADEMIC COUNCIL Meeting Minutes			
Thursday, 21 MARCH 2024		**11:00 am – 1:30 pm**	**CLASSROOM: HUB111**
CHAIRPERSON	Dr. Dima Jamali (DJ)	Chair & Vice-President Academic Affairs	Present
ATTENDEES	Ms. Walaa Yassien (WY)	Academic Support Officer, FCAS	Present
	Dr. Habib Fardoun (HF)	Vice-President, Research & Excellence	Apologies
	Dr. Rami El-Khatib (RK)	Dean, Student Affairs	Present
	Dr. Kathy O'Sullivan (KO)	Dean, First Year Students	Present
	Dr. Kweh Qian Long (KL)	Dean, Research and Innovation	Present
	Dr. Aseel Takshe (AT)	Acting Dean, FCAS	Present
	Dr. William Smith (WS)	HOD, Communications & Media, FCAS	Present
	Dr. Stefane Mostefa Kabene (SK)	HOD, Social Sciences, FCAS	Apologies
	Dr. Taghreed Masri (TM)	Coordinator, General Education & Language, FCAS	Present
	Mr. Massimo Imparato (MI)	Dean, SAID	Present
	Dr. Maha Salman (MS)	HOD, Interior Design, SAID	Present
	Dr. Seif Khaiti (SK)	HOD, Architecture, SAID	Apologies
	Dr. Constantin Spiridonidis (CS)	Professor, SAID	Present
	Dr. Sherif Moussa (SM)	Dean, SEAST	Present
	Dr. Syed Zamberi (SZ)	Acting Dean, SOM	Present
	Dr. Davide Contu (DC)	Associate Dean, SOM	Present
	Dr. Rommel Sergio (RS)	Coordinator, BBA in Human Resources Management, SOM	Present
	Dr. Ikhlaas Gurrib (IG)	Coordinator, BBA in Finance & Accounting, SOM	Present

	Dr. Farooq Haq (FH)	Coordinator, BBA in Marketing, Luxury Marketing & Internatio Business and MBA in Marketing, SOM	Present
	Dr. Mohamed Abdelhakim (MA)	Coordinator, BBA in E-Business, MITM, SOM	Present
Administration			
ATTENDEES	Mr. Mohammad Elmoshnib (ME)	Registrar	Present
	Dr. Anwar Abaidullah (AA)	Director, IRP	Present
	Mrs. Menchie Armillo (MA)	Director, LRC	Present
	Mr. Aftab Khan (AK)	Director, ICT	Present

No.	Items	Responsible	Deadline	Completed
1.	**Approval of Minutes 25th January, 24** Motion to approve the minutes **Motion moved by: Dr. Kathy O'Sullivan** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Rommel Sergio**	Recorded All present AC members		
2.	**Approval of Agenda** Motion to approve the agenda **Motion moved by: Dr. Sherif Moussa** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Maha Salman**	Recorded All present AC members		
3.	**Safety Moment –** Dr. Dima Jamali (DJ)			

4.	**Academic Affairs –** Dr. Dima Jamali (DJ) ➢ CUD has a main strategic shift for next Academic Year. ➢ Main strategic purpose is to increase research quality and output. ➢ Innovation ~~teaching~~ in teaching aiming for better engagement. ➢ Add more incentives in place and a rigorous support structure~~further incentive~~. a) Administrative Teaching Release Proposal ➢ Academic leaders often struggle to balance administrative duties with teaching responsibilities. ➢ Teaching release for administrators is crucial to ensure effective management of administrative tasks while maintaining educational standards. ➢ The office of the Vice President for Academic Affairs (VPA) at CUD is conducting a comparative study on the release time of academic administrators. ➢ The aim is to enhance academic quality at CUD through informed decisions regarding teaching release policies for administrators. ➢ CUD will be compensating faculty with providing teaching release instead of providing a stipend • If the department is managing over 150 students, Program Chair will get 06 hours credit release • Associate Deans currently have 03 credit release, and they are expected to have 06 credit release Motion to approve this item **Motion moved by: Dr. Farooq Haq** **Motion seconded by: Mr. Massimo Imparato**	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	b) Research Vs Teaching Track Policy ➢ The policy at Canadian University Dubai (CUD) delineates expectations for faculty members in research and teaching tracks, aiming to provide students with a comprehensive learning experience. It emphasizes: ➢ a) Faculty engagement in cutting-edge research to expose students to advancements in their field. ➢ b) Innovative teaching methodologies to cultivate critical thinking and innovation in students. ➢ c) Alignment with the UAE's vision for a knowledge-based economy, promoting entrepreneurship, innovation, and human capital development. ➢ Faculty tracks: • Research-Oriented Track ○ Research-oriented track faculty members must have a strong research record, including publication in high-impact Scopus-indexed journals and securing research funding. ○ Faculty members on this track have various responsibilities including: a) Conducting impactful research to advance their field. b) Actively seeking research funding from federal and/or private agencies. c) Mentoring students and postdocs for research publications.	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	d) Collaborating with industry partners to promote multidisciplinary cooperation. e) Presenting research findings at conferences, workshops, and seminars for publication and dissemination. ○ Evaluation criteria for research-oriented track faculty members focus on research productivity, interdisciplinary and international network, and research impacts. ○ Teaching contributions are acknowledged but carry less weight for evaluation. ○ Service contributions, such as departmental committees and academic advising, are also significant for faculty success. • Teaching-Oriented Track ○ Teaching-oriented track appointments emphasize excellent teaching, curriculum development, and student advising and retention, evidenced by strong student evaluations, innovative teaching methods, and contributions to curriculum enhancement. ○ Teaching-Oriented Track faculty members' duties at CUD include: a) Creating and delivering engaging courses that promote critical thinking, problem-solving skills, and knowledge acquisition. b) Refining curriculum materials to ensure relevance, up to date, and alignment with learning objectives.	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	c) Giving students timely and helpful feedback to improve academically and on their career matters. d) Attending workshops and conferences on innovative teaching methods to improve teaching abilities and pedagogy. ○ Evaluation of faculty members in this track focuses on teaching effectiveness, peer reviews of teaching methods, student engagement, and pedagogical innovations. ○ While research contributions are acknowledged, they carry less weight for evaluation purposes. ○ Service contributions, including departmental committee involvement, student advising, curriculum development, and student support services, are also valued. • Performance Assessment Formula ○ Subject to the approval of the Vice President of Academic Affairs, the weightings for various performance areas will be determined collaboratively by the school dean and each faculty member at the start of each academic year, considering the chosen track and individual strengths. These weightings will be applied to the following core areas: ○ Teaching: Delivering engaging and impactful courses. ○ Research: Conducting original research and contributing to knowledge advancement.	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	○ Outreach, Administration, and Advising: Contributing to the broader university community through activities such as service, advising, and public engagement. ➢ KPI are prepared to include in the oracle for measuring faculty performance across tracks. ➢ Key faculty KPI's are: • Standard (60%,20%,20%) • Research (20%,80%,20%) • Teaching (80%,5%,15%) ➢ Dynamic KPI Strategies: • Data-Driven Decision Making • Policy Papers • Review Impact and Outcomes ➢ This item will be finalized after finalizing the roadshow presentation and soliciting feedback from faculty and schools. ➢ Policy for Embracing Pedagogical Innovations at CUD. ➢ Policy on Scientific Publications. c) Embracing Teaching Innovations Policy ➢ Canadian University Dubai (CUD) expects faculty members to use innovative teaching methods. ➢ Methods include interactive case studies, simulations, gamification, flipped classroom, and technology-integrated solutions.	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	➢ The goal is to foster critical thinking and knowledge acquisition. ➢ This approach prepares students for success in the modern world. ➢ CUD encourages and supports faculty members to use diverse and innovative teaching methodologies. • The aim is to enhance student learning experiences. ➢ Performance Assessment Framework • Performance assessment for faculty members will consider their effectiveness in implementing innovative teaching methods, student engagement, and achievement of learning outcomes. • The following areas will be evaluated: ○ Teaching: Effectiveness and Innovation in designing and delivering courses using innovative methodologies. ○ Technology Integration: Integration of tech-led education disrupting solutions such as simulations, games, videos, collaborative tools, tech platforms and multi-media resources including interactive digital case studies. ○ Experiential Learning Integration: Integration of experiential and immersive practical learning experiences including field visits, guest speakers, role plays and debates. ○ Professional Development: Participation in activities to enhance teaching skills and stay abreast of emerging trends.	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	○ Student Engagement: Degree of student involvement and interaction in the learning process including flipped classrooms and interactive presentations. • CUD will provide support and resources for integrating innovative teaching methods into the curriculum. ○ This support includes access to training workshops, technological infrastructure, and technical assistance for course development and implementation. d) Post Doc Policy ➢ CUD is initiating a Post-Doctoral Appointment Scheme. ➢ This scheme is designed to attract top-notch researchers to Canadian University Dubai (CUD), which will help improve our research excellence and productivity. ➢ The main objectives of this scheme: • Increase high-impact publications and overall research excellence. • Facilitate groundbreaking discoveries and technological advancements. • Strengthen and broaden international research collaborations. • Improve CUD standing in key university rankings. ➢ Appointment Authority • The CUD Post-Doctoral Appointment Committee, chaired by the Vice President of Academic Affairs, evaluates and selects applications recommended by a faculty member who will supervise the postdoc. The committee comprises: a) School Dean (from the supervisor's school).	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	b) Dean of Research and Innovation. c) HR Manager. d) Faculty member with expertise similar to the ~~to the~~ postdoc.~~'s~~ ~~supervise.~~			
	➢ Applications Qualifications a) Applications are open to scholars globally, excluding current CUD employees. b) Candidates must have earned a PhD within five years of application submission. c) Strong publication record in Scopus-indexed journals with impact factors from the Web of Science (WoS) is required. d) Research expertise of applicants must align with the supervisor's focus area.	Recorded All present AC members		
	➢ Supervisors' Qualifications a) Supervisors should possess a high Scopus H-index score (≥10) and a track record of high-impact Scopus-indexed publications with impact factors from WoS. b) Supervisors should not have supervised any recent CUD Post-Doctoral candidates using university allocations. c) Supervisors' research expertise must align with CUD's research mission.	Recorded All present AC members		
	➢ Duties and Responsibilities • Post-Doctoral Research~~es~~			

	○ Conduct research under supervisor's guidance and achieve set KPIs such as publishing research findings in high-impact Scopus-indexed journals. ○ Submit progress reports every three months and a final report upon completion. • Supervisors ○ Oversee the research project to meet set KPIs. ○ Ensure timely submission of progress reports and documents. ➢ Appointment and Re-appointment • Appointments are offered on a contract basis, with minimum durations of 12 months (1 year) and maximums of 24 months (2 years). • One one-time extension can be considered based on satisfactory performance (such as meeting KPIs), sufficient funding, and the supervisor's recommendation. • Minimum salary standards as per the CUD HR compensation policy. ➢ Funding Sources • University Allocations: Funded directly by CUD, subject to specific HR guidelines on hiring and compensation. • Registered Research Grants: Funded by active external grants registered with CUD.	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	➢ Application Procedure • Submit the following documents to the CUD HR: ○ Curriculum Vitae ○ Research Proposal & Work Schedule ○ Academic Certificates and Publications List • Shortlisted candidates may be invited for interviews. e) Performance Evaluation and KPIs ➢ Discussed in point (b. Research Vs Teaching Track Policy). f) Guidelines for ChatGPT ➢ Establishment of a Task Force to address the integration of AI tools like ChatGPT into teaching and research. ➢ Task Force will develop Guidelines for faculty to navigate this new reality effectively. ➢ Guidelines will serve as a resource to help educators adapt to the changing environment and capitalize on AI opportunities. ➢ VPAA – Dr. Dima Jamali – encourages faculty to approach her for any inquiries or feedback. • Code of Conduct	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	○ Academic Integrity: Ensure compliance with CUD's integrity guidelines when utilizing AI tools, reminding students about plagiarism risks with AI-generated content and ensuring proper citation of AI usage. ○ Integration of AI in Courses: Utilize AI to enrich student learning and participation, potentially transforming teaching approaches, class interactions, and assignments. ○ Adjusting Assessments: Adapt assessments to monitor AI utilization; utilize AI detection tools for evaluation and inform students about their usage. ○ Assessing AI in Student Work: Continuously evaluate the influence of AI on assessment formats such as oral presentations and written tasks to uphold academic integrity. • Learning with AI ○ Supporting Diverse Learning: Utilize AI tools for language translation and summarization to cater to diverse learning preferences. ○ Data-Driven Learning: Harness AI's analytical capabilities and data processing functionalities to enrich data-focused educational experiences.	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	○ Development of Critical Thinking: Foster critical thinking skills in students by prompting them to analyze and assess information obtained from AI tools critically. ○ Establishment of Clear AI Usage Guidelines: Offer clear and transparent instructions, including citation requirements, for students utilizing AI tools in their academic work. • Ethics in AI Usage ○ Emphasizing Human Judgment: Highlight the significance of human decision-making in navigating complex ethical dilemmas associated with AI usage. ○ Monitoring and Understanding AI: Supervise AI utilization for safety measures and educate students about its limitations and inherent biases. ○ Staying Informed and Secure: Stay abreast of AI advancements while prioritizing student data privacy and security in AI application. ○ Support and Evaluation: Help students utilizing AI tools and continuously evaluate the efficacy of AI integration in teaching to ensure student achievement.	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	g) Guidelines for Professor of Practice ➢ CUD initiating the Proposal for Introducing Professor of Practice as Faculty Track ➢ Hiring Challenges • Difficulty in recruiting expert practitioners without a Ph.D. in areas like fine arts and communication, architecture, or even business. ➢ Current Hiring Practices • Such experts are often limited to roles as Assistant Professors or Lecturers. ➢ New Track Proposal • Suggesting a "Professor of Practice" track for experienced masters-degree holders. ➢ Degree Recognition • Identifying certain degrees as suitable for higher academic ranks. ➢ Strategic Approach • This proposal is part of a broader strategy to enhance faculty appointments in specialized fields. ➢ Standards for Professor of Practice: • Role and Evaluation: Associate Professors of Practice (APoP) and Professors of Practice (PoP) are hired for their expertise in fields like arts, business, and engineering, and are evaluated based on professional practice and contributions.	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	• Appointment Process: Deans, in consultation with department chairs, submit evaluation rubrics and criteria for positions to the Vice President~~Chancellor~~ for Academic Affairs (VPAA) for approval before advertising the position. • Faculty Limit and Service: Limit for such positions is 20% of a college's faculty, extendable to 25% with President approval. APoP and PoP undertake all department duties, including community service. • Leadership Eligibility and Degree Requirements: Eligible for leadership roles like Department Chair/Dean. While advanced degrees are preferred, a Ph.D. is not mandatory. A minimum of an M.Sc. degree and a significant track record of professional impact are required. • Regulatory Compliance: Aligns with UAE Commission for Academic Accreditation regulations, allowing up to 20% of faculty in specific programs to be exceptions to the terminal degree requirement. ➢ Proposed Hiring and Renewal Guidelines • Initial appointment criteria for positions like Associate Professor of Practice or Professor of Practice require: ○ Demonstrated professional impact through substantial practical experience. ○ Recognized distinction and significant influence in the field.	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	• Candidates must undergo a full appointment process according to university policies.
	• Deans, in consultation with department chairs, establish minimum criteria for these positions based on disciplinary norms.
	• Appointees should have a well-established reputation for superior accomplishments, evidenced by:
	  ○ Published works or presentations beyond traditional scholarly channels.
	  ○ Adherence to standards of quality and impact equivalent to other research contributions within the University.
	• Renewal criteria for Associate Professors of Practice and Professors of Practice emphasize:
	  ○ Maintaining current professional expertise.
	  ○ Bringing high levels of professional expertise to teaching, supported by research-based evidence.
	  ○ Maintaining significant influence and presence in their field.
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	• APoP and PoP may be appointed at 50% time or less, where they should support the university's agenda in providing students with clear pathways towards industrial practical training and employability. • If appointed at 100% time, the appointee's full professional commitment must be to the University. • The percentage of APoP and PoP appointments should not exceed 20% of the total full-time faculty in any college without approval from the VPAA and the President.	Recorded All present AC members		

	• Promotion to higher ranks of Associate Professor of Practice (APoP) or Professor of Practice (PoP) is contingent upon adherence to hiring and renewal guidelines set by the college and approved by the VPAA. • Contract duration for APoP / PoP is set at two years. • Appointments at the APoP / PoP level will be determined based on field-specific requirements. • Salary scale proposed for APoP / PoP aligns with that of Associate Professors and Professors at CUD. h) Awards at CUD ➢ To foster a culture of achievement, motivation, and innovation within the CUD community, we propose the introduction of four Annual Awards for Excellence, along with a Staff Excellence Award for non-academic staff members. The awards categories are: a) Teaching Innovation Award b) Research Excellence Award c) Community Impact Award d) Staff Excellence Award ➢ Each year, one awardee will be selected for each category. The inaugural award cycle is planned to commence during the graduation ceremony~~with a public ceremony~~ in May 2024.	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	➢ Eligibility criteria for applicants include: • Current, full-time employment status at CUD with a minimum of one year of service at the time of application. • Submission of a completed Application Form, endorsed by both the Dean of Faculty/School and the VPAA, following a review of the development plan and achievements by the Dean. ➢ Further discussions regarding judging and execution will be conducted by the Deans in an upcoming meeting.	Recorded All present AC members		
	➢ Teaching Innovation Award • The award recognizes faculty members who excel in implementing innovative teaching methods to enhance student learning experiences at CUD, fostering an environment of educational advancement through the integration of technology and diverse innovative tactics in teaching. • Terms of Reference ○ The School Dean nominates one faculty member to the Vice President of Academic Affairs for the award based on: a) 20% – the average course evaluation score for the last academic year or the past two semesters (both Fall and Spring semesters).	Recorded All present AC members		

		- Data source: the School Dean should obtain official records of their faculty members' course evaluation scores from the IRP office. b) 20% – the level of excellence and thoroughness in teaching portfolio. - Data source: Completion of teaching course files (15%) in the scale of 3-5 with 3 being unsatisfactory, 4 being acceptable, and 5 being excellent. c) 40% – Integrating Innovation, Creativity, and Emerging Technologies in Teaching. - The assessment criteria for the incorporation of innovative teaching methods, such as flipped classroom techniques, interactive simulations, and case studies, will be graded on a scale of 3-5, where 3 denotes unsatisfactory, 4 signifies acceptable, and 5 indicates excellent performance. - This criterion aims to recognize faculty members who contribute actively to revolutionizing traditional teaching approaches by introducing fresh,	Recorded All present AC members		

	creative, and effective methods into the classroom. The objective is to inspire educators to explore unconventional strategies that engage and motivate students, fostering an environment of continual improvement and adaptability in teaching practices. - Activities assessed include: • Incorporation of innovative teaching methods, such as flipped classroom techniques, interactive simulations, gamification, and case studies. • Integration of renowned guest speakers and field trips to enrich the learning experience. • Demonstration of integrating cutting-edge technologies, such as virtual reality, augmented reality, or artificial intelligence, into the curriculum to enhance the learning experience. - All activities will be evaluated using the same grading scale to ensure consistency and fairness in assessment.	Recorded All present AC members		

		d) 20% – Professional Development and Continued Learning. - The assessment will consider the faculty member's dedication to their professional development in teaching and learning documented through: • Participation in workshops, conferences, or other educational events aimed at improving teaching skills and staying updated on educational trends. • Involvement in community engagement activities related to education, such as contributions to educational outreach programs or partnerships with local organizations. • Initiatives connecting the institution with the broader community, showcasing the faculty member's commitment to educational outreach and community impact.	Recorded All present AC members		

	➢ Research Eexcellence Award
	
	• This award recognizes faculty for exceptional research contributions, emphasizing academic excellence at CUD. Candidates should have a significant number of Scopus-Indexed publications, particularly in Q1 and Q2 journals, and be well-regarded in their field. Demonstrated international collaborations elevating CUD's reputation globally are also essential.
	
	• Terms of Reference
	
	  ○ The Dean of Research and Innovation should nominate an awardee to the Vice President of Academic Affairs with evidence of:
	  a) 30% – the number of (Q1 – 70% and Q2 – 30%) Scopus-indexed publications in the latest calendar year.
	  Data source: the Scopus data extraction and quartile mapping by the CUD library. For example, 0.7 * 5 points * number of Q1 Scopus-indexed publications + 0.3 * 5 points * number of Q2 Scopus-indexed publications. The
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		faculty members with rank 1 in the sum of scores will be given 5 points, rank 2 = 4 points, and rank 3 = 3 points. b) 30% – the growth rate of citations in the Scopus database in the latest calendar year. - Data source: the Scopus database. The faculty members with rank 1 in the growth rate will be given 5 points, rank 2 = 4 points, and rank 3 = 3 points. c) 20% – the number of Scopus-indexed publications with international collaboration (70%) and multidisciplinary topics (30%) in the latest calendar year. - Data source: the Scopus database. For example, 0.7 * 5 points * number of Scopus-indexed publications with international collaboration + 0.3 * 5 points * number of Scopus-indexed publications with multidisciplinary topics. The faculty members with rank 1 in the sum of scores will be given 5 points, rank 2 = 4 points, and rank 3 = 3 points.	Recorded All present AC members		

	d) 20% – the number of Scopus-indexed publications on topics related to sustainability in the latest calendar year. - Data source: the Scopus database. The faculty members with rank 1 in nb of sustainability-related publications will be given 5 points, rank 2 = 4 points, and rank 3 = 3 points.	Recorded All present AC members		

	➢ Community Impact Award
	• The award aims to recognize faculty members for their engagement in community activities, benefiting the CUD, local, and global communities.
	• Emphasis is placed on fostering a culture of social involvement and accountability.
	• The awardee should have actively participated in university-wide activities and promoted CUD through cooperative community engagement.
	• Contributions should align with CUD's dedication to creating enduring societal impacts and strategic focus areas such as entrepreneurship and innovation.
	• Tearms of Reference for eligibility
	  ○ The applicant must be a current, full time academic with at least one year at CUD at the time of application.
	  ○ Addressed a need identified by the community partner and developed a partnership with the community partner.
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	○ Demonstrated a reciprocal benefit between CUD and the community partner. • Requirements ○ Filled Application Form that is signed off by both Dean of Faculty/School and the VPAA after reviewing the development plan and achievements by the Dean. ○ Recommendation letter from the community partner that highlights the achievements of the nominee and the impact of partnership on the community. • To nominate a candidate for the Community Impact award to the Vice President of Academic Affairs, the School Dean must assess their faculty member's professional development plan from the previous academic year. Upon receiving an application, the School Dean should furnish evidence pertaining to the following details: a) 20% – the number of community engagement activities within CUD. - Data source: Faculty member's professional development plan for the last academic year. The faculty members with rank 1 in the sum of numbers will be given 5 points, rank 2 = 4 points, and rank 3 = 3 points. (and any other arising engagements that support the application). b) 20% – the impact of community engagement within CUD.	Recorded All present AC members		

		- Data source: This can be measured through the number of students involved, and the feedback from students and other stakeholders. c) 30% – the number of community outreach outside CUD. - Data source: Faculty member's professional development plan for the last academic year. The faculty members with rank 1 in the sum of numbers will be given 5 points, rank 2 = 4 points, and rank 3 = 3 points. (and any other arising engagements that support the application). d) 30% – the impact of community outreach outside CUD. Data source: Faculty member's professional development plan for the last academic year. The faculty members with rank 1 in the sum of numbers will be given 5 points, rank 2 = 4 points, and rank 3 = 3 points. - Data source: This can be measured through feedback and testimonials by external community members in relation to the impact generated through specific activities (recommendation letters, feedback surveys, media coverages, etc). ○ The School Dean should keep the collected evidence in his/her nomination process. If there is a tie between two or more faculty members, the School/Faculty Dean in consultation with the VPAA has the discretion to	Recorded All present AC members		

	nominate the best faculty member in terms of community engagement based on his/her professional and fair judgment. ➢ Staff Excellence Award • The award aims to acknowledge the exceptional contributions of non-academic university staff, emphasizing their leadership and services. CUD values their role in fostering a positive and collaborative workplace, supporting the university's vision and mission, and enhancing the overall experience of students, faculty, and the university community. • Terms and References ○ Either the VPAA or the COO will distribute a structured survey to determine the recipient of the Staff Excellence Award. This survey aims to gather feedback from colleagues and supervisors at CUD, ensuring a fair and inclusive evaluation process.	Recorded All present AC members		
5.	**Learning Resources Centre –** Menchie Armillo (MA) a) Course textbooks/ref/instructor's resources ➢ LRC started collecting the resources list from faculty.	Recorded All present AC members		

	➢ Copyright issues should be ~~with~~ discussed with VPAA, approval from VPAA is a must prior to any resource acquisition.
	➢ Faculty are recommended to provide the Syllabus alongside their resources suggestion.
	➢ VPAA requested academics to action looking into the most updated materials and textbooks for courses.
	  ○ The main textbook should be up to date (2000 and above)
	  ○ Any valuable materials that emphasize the subject importance can be added as part of the materials supplementary readings
	➢ Faculty need to ensure the latest Syllabi are added and updated and a final version should be shared with AA from IRP.
	➢ LRC will request from the Deans to send the updated syllabi.
	➢ Courses resources required for Summer 23-24 are complete and needs to approve in the LRC.
	➢ All Fall Syllabi must be updated by mid-June, and with IRP as a last step.
	
	b) Students project (repository)
	
	➢ Faculty are encouraged to deposit student projects in LRC repository.
	➢ Student work will be showcased, and this will help them archive it.
	➢ A declaration form is prepared and must be signed by Faculty and S~~s~~tudents.
		Recorded
		
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6.	**School of Management** – Davide Contu (DC) a) New BBAs in Entrepreneurship and Management ➢ The **BBA in Entrepreneurship** and the **BBA in Management** are two new BBA programs being developed in line with the strategic goals of CUD and SOM. ➢ They are listed in the current **SOM Business Plan** as Game changer and key initiatives. ➢ They are ideated to meet market demand, align with SOM mission as well as Dubai Economy's Agenda (e.g., D33) and international best practices. ➢ Prior to presenting this to the Academic Council, ~~-~~a collegial process of review and feedback started in 2019 from advisory board, task forces, AOL Committee, and finally the Curriculum Committee. ➢ The main idea is to prepare ~~make~~ students to be ~~the~~ real entrepreneurs. ➢ Main goals were identified for the new BBA in Entrepreneurship program • Graduates will be knowledgeable in Entrepreneurship and Business administration. • Graduates will be equipped with the skills to identify new business opportunities. • Graduates will have developed competencies to start a new business or contribute to existing businesses. ➢ BBA in Entrepreneurship PLOs • Demonstrate knowledge of principles and theories related to entrepreneurship and their application to business contexts.	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	• Communicate effectively orally and in writing to demonstrate successful business management skills. • Analyze data using quantitative and qualitative methods for decision making. • Function effectively as a member or leader of a team and engage in activities that align with the professional and societal norms, regulations, and ethical values. • Engage in lifelong learning and acquiring new knowledge and skills with an attitude that is conducive to professional development and growth. • Demonstrate the understanding of the global dimensions of business and entrepreneurship including markets, cultures, policies, and regulations. • Apply specialized entrepreneurship knowledge and tools to effectively compete in local and global markets. • Identify and explore entrepreneurship opportunities in a market, whilst developing and implementing innovative and sustainable solutions.	Recorded All present AC members Recorded		
	➢ Main goals were identified for the new BBA in Management program • Graduates will be knowledgeable about management disciplines to enable them to contribute effectively to the evolving business landscape. • Graduates will be equipped with skills to be competent and successful in management embracing new technologies and sustainability principles. • Graduates will have the ability to identify the most appropriate approach for conducting individual or team duties and responsibilities efficiently.	All present AC members		

	➢ BBA in Management PLOs • Demonstrate knowledge of principles and theories related to management and their application to business contexts. • Communicate effectively orally and in writing to demonstrate successful business management skills. • Analyze data using quantitative and qualitative methods for decision making. • Function effectively as a member or leader of a team and engage in activities that align with the professional and societal norms, regulations, and ethical values. • Engage in lifelong learning and acquiring new knowledge and skills with an attitude that is conducive to professional development and growth. • Demonstrate the understanding of the global dimensions of business, including markets, cultures, policies, and regulations. • Apply specialized management principles and theories to a national and global business context to develop strategies for organizations. • Analyze management problems, formulate innovative and sustainable solutions and develop effective strategies. ➢ Moving forward the main key points to highlight: • Mission: Develop future leaders and entrepreneurs through transformative academic experiences. • Guiding Principles: Commitment to rigorous and practical education, high corporate ethics, and impactful research.	Recorded All present AC members		

	• Objectives: Promote entrepreneurial excellence, emerging technologies, and innovation. • Impact: Betterment of local and global communities served by CUD. ➢ DC shared the curriculum plan for the new programs and discussed the changes with the collective. **Discussion:** VPAA expressed gratitude to the School of Management and its Curriculum Committee for their proactive approach in embracing necessary modifications to synchronize programs and update the curriculum to adhere to global standards. Motion to approve this item **Motion moved by: Dr. Mohamed Abdelhakim** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Aseel Takshe**	Recorded All present AC members		
7.	**School of Engineering, Applied Science & Technology** – Sherif Moussa (SM) a) Approval of the program structure and curriculum of BSc. In power and renewable energy Engineering ➢ SEAST presented the program structure and curriculum of B.Sc. in Bachelor of Science in Power and Renewable Energy Engineering (BScPREE).	Recorded All present AC members		

	➢ The program was presented for approval in the Academic Council Meeting in 2021 and the approval was paused. ➢ The program was designed to be a standalone program and the course structure was modified and courses and labs were modified. ➢ SM presented the curriculum and Study Plan and discussed with IRP any queries for the collective. **Discussion:** VPAA expressed gratitude to the School of Engineering~~Management~~ and its Curriculum Committee for their proactive approach in embracing necessary modifications to synchronize programs and update the curriculum to adhere to global standards Motion to approve this item **Motion moved by: Dr. Maha Salman** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Kathy O'Sullivan**	Recorded All present AC members		
	b) Semester load for year 4 of Computer Science, cyber security, and software design programs ➢ Computing Programs Graduation Projects are having 06 Credit Hours in one go and placed in the Fall Semester instead of 03 Credit Hours in two semesters. ➢ Students requiring taking an extra course to graduate are not able to do so because there is no more room for more Credit hours due to the graduation project of 06 Credit Hours.	Recorded All present AC members		

	➢ SM requested the approval to increase extra credit hours students can take considering the current graduation project is taking work over two semesters. • The recommendation was discussed and agreed with Registrar ➢ SM discussed the study plan of the computer science program. ➢ AA confirmed students can take up to 21 Credit Hours in the last academic year if they are graduating. **Discussion:** VPAA requested from SM to discuss~~ed~~ with Registrar having the graduation project credit hours split into two semesters (two courses) (i.e. Project I, Project II) or (Level 1, Level II).			
8.	**Research & Innovation** – Kweh Qian Long (KL) a) Research-related policies ➢ Proposed APC Claim policy • The main objective of this guideline is intended to enhance the prominence and influence of Canadian University Dubai (CUD) research by boosting citations via high-impact or open-access publications. • KL shared the Research Publication Funding Guidelines and Procedures ○ This document outlines guidelines for CUD researchers, facilitating funding requests for research publication. It covers Article Processing Charges and Open	Recorded All present AC members		

	Access costs, aiming to promote high-quality research aligned with CUD priorities and international networks. While focused on journal articles, funding for other formats is considered case by case. Researchers must adhere to CUD publication policy and be aware of budget constraints and internal review processes. Continual optimization of research support is a commitment, with potential future expansions to these guidelines.
	• Application requirements
	  ○ Applications open to all CUD researchers (faculty, postdoc, research assistants). Funding for publication costs (Article Processing Charge, Open Access) is limited to Q1 Scopus-indexed journals with Web of Science impact factors. Publications must align with CUD research priorities, with the applicant as corresponding author and CUD affiliation. Acknowledgement of CUD support is required. Maximum five authors per publication, special approval needed for more. One application allowed per year.
	• Funding
	  ○ Funding approved is for article publication involving Publication Costs (Article Processing Charge) and Open Access. Applicants must adhere to all financial regulations and directives in force at CUD.
		Recorded
		
		All present AC members
		
		Recorded
		
		All present AC members		

	• Application procedures ○ Applications for publication funding must be submitted one month before publication and endorsed by relevant deans. Required documents include acceptance letter, Scopus indexing evidence, full paper, payment details, and proof of upload to CUD-DSpace. Payment claims must be submitted within one month after publication. • The Research and Innovation Office reserves the right not to process applications if they do not meet the above criteria or are submitted beyond the specified period.	Recorded All present AC members		

	➢ Policy on Scientific Publications
	• This policy sets the guidelines for maintaining academic standard and scholarly integrity throughout the research and publication process at Canadian University Dubai (CUD).
	• Scope and application
	  ○ This policy encompasses all CUD-affiliated scholars, including faculty members, collaborative researchers, and students, engaged in research and publication activities, irrespective of funding or publication venue.
	• KL identified Scientific and Scholarly Publications
	  ○ Scientific articles including original/research articles, review articles, and other equivalent indexed in the Scopus database (https://www.scopus.com).
		Recorded
		
		All present AC members		

	○ Books/book chapters published by reputable publishers and indexed in the Scopus database. ○ Conference articles published in conferences proceedings that are indexed in the Scopus database. ○ Scientific reports or portfolio of intellectual contributions from applied and pedagogical research. ○ Copyrights, patents and trademarks recognized by either the Intellectual Property Law in the UAE (https://www.moec.gov.ae/en/intellectual-property-legislations) or United States Patent and Trademark Office (USPTO) (http://www.uspto.gov). • Predatory Journals and Publishers • This policy is subject to periodic review and revision. CUD reserves the right to vary or amend the policy at its sole discretion at any time.	Recorded All present AC members		
	➢ Proposed Conference Attendance Request Guidelines • This policy provides CUD full-time faculty members with the necessary information to navigate the application process of conference attendance request, in order to support them in participating in academic conferences to: ○ facilitate their ongoing professional development, ○ encourage networking and collaboration, and ○ enhance the reputation and research visibility of CUD.	Recorded All present AC members		

	• Eligibility and Selection Criteria: ○ Applications will be assessed according to the conference's academic significance, potential benefits to the faculty member's research, and alignment with the strategic objectives of CUD. The assessment will also include the following points: a) The faculty member is the first author or corresponding author. b) The faculty member serves key conference roles such as paper presenter, session chair, reviewer, and workshop organizer. c) Faculty members with a track record of research productivity. d) Early-career faculty members (within the first three years of their employment) seeking research exposure and networking opportunities may be prioritized.	Recorded All present AC members		

	e) Faculty members who have received internal conference attendance funding within the last academic year may be given a lesser priority in the approval process. f) The conference theme must be linked to the faculty member's research area. g) The submitted scholarly work must be aligned with school or university research priorities. • Application Guidelines ○ Faculty members should email the following details to his/her School Dean through his/her respective academic support officer at least one month before the scheduled conference: a) Conference attendance request form, b) A copy of the official invitation letter from the organizing committee of the academic conference to the applicant OR a copy of the proof of acceptance of the paper, c) A copy each of the abstract and full text of the submitted scholarly work for presentation, including keywords, d) Approved leave application form.	Recorded All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	• The School Dean should check the necessary operational arrangement related to conference travel including make-up classes and substitute instructor. All applications will next be reviewed by the Dean of Research and Innovation before the final approval by the Vice-President of Academic Affairs, in accordance with the guidelines for supporting faculty members attending academic conferences in the CUD faculty handbook. • KL mentioned Financial Assistance Details. • This policy is subject to periodic review and revision. CUD reserves the right to vary or amend the policy at its sole discretion at any time. ➢ Proposed Conference Attendance Request Form • KL shared a proposed conference attached request form. **Discussion:** VPAA requested the policies to be circulated to all academic council members for feedback.	Recorded All present AC members		
9.	**School of Architecture & Interior Design** – Constantin Spiridonidis (CS) a) MSc Design for the Circular Economy (for presentation and approval) ➢ MI explained the previous SAID proposal in the Academic Council for two bachelor programs and one master program. ➢ SAID accelerated the process of drafting the documents for the master's program.	Recorded All present AC members		

	• The School Council, Curriculum Committee and IRP were involved in prior approvals. ➢ CS presented MSc in Design for the Circular Economy by highlighting the importance oif Design on one hand and Circular Economy on the other hand. ➢ Program educational goals • Cultivate graduates' profound understanding of the human-driven climate crisis as a fatal thread for the planet's life. • Foster multi/cross/inter/disciplinary approaches to the global design industry for prompt, multifaceted, and impactful mitigation and adaptation strategies. • Foster in graduates diverse, interdisciplinary approaches to the global design industry for prompt, multifaceted, and impactful mitigation and adaptation strategies. • Equip Graduates with a comprehensive understanding of the core principles, strategies, and tools of Circular Economy. • Gain insights into the shift from linear to circular production models to foster innovative design practices and decision-making. • Enhance graduates' insights into the shift from linear to circular production models to foster innovative design practices and decision-making. • Foster a culture that recognizes that humanity's survival and prosperity depend on living in harmony with nature. • Develop a culture in graduates that recognizes that humanity's survival and prosperity depend on living in harmony with nature.	Recorded All present AC members		

	• Drive graduates towards cross-disciplinary design practices that envision a symbiosis of human and non-human entities, while prioritizing sustainability and equity. • Prepare graduates able to synthesize Climate Change concerns and Circular Economy directives into innovative design strategies, supported by speculations about future culture/nature symbiosis. • Enable graduates to implement Circular Economy driven entrepreneurial projects leading to innovative pathways, processes, methods for the achievement of a more sustainable future. • Equip graduates with advanced skills in data collection, management, and analysis, to enhance their professional decision-making and design skills. ➢ Program Learning Outcomes • Demonstrate an in-depth understanding of Climate Crisis as a human-led threat to our planet and as a design by-product. • Understand Design as a human values-driven activity that significantly impacts our lives and the natural world. • Discuss Design as a human values-driven activity that significantly impacts our lives and the natural world. • Demonstrate an in-depth understanding of how transitioning from linear consumption patterns to circular ones through the Circular Economy can mitigate the Climate Crisis. • Assess how transitioning from linear consumption patterns to circular ones through the Circular Economy can mitigate the Climate Crisis.	Recorded All present AC members		

	• Apply circular economy principles and methods to the development of diverse design strategies for business and entrepreneurship upholding the ecosystem's balance and promoting a sustainable, equitable, and resilient future. • Implement innovative pathways, processes, methods, and data use to design environments, activities, and products that consider the directives of the Circular Economy and the threads of the Climate Crisis. • Apply cutting-edge computational tools and methods to mine, analyze, and manage complex data, to implement Circular Economy principles in the designs of environments, activities, and products. • Recognize the importance of blending critical and speculative design thinking to forge innovative professional projects rooted in Circular Economy. ➢ CS shared the program structure and courses involved **Discussion:** VPAA requested more information on the interdisciplinary of this master's program. Also to consider the 20% component online for some of our Masters programs and MBA upon securing~~granting~~ the ministry's approval to facilitate and accommodate the busy lives of working~~to~~ professionals. Motion to approve this item (with minor changes) **Motion moved by: Dr. Sherif Moussa** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Rommel Sergio**	Recorded All present AC members		

10.	**<u>Adjournment of meeting</u>** The meeting was adjourned at 01:45 pm.			

CANADIAN UNIVERSITY DUBAI
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ACADEMIC COUNCIL Meeting Minutes			
Monday, 29 APRIL 2024		**11:00 pm – 01:30 pm**	**CLASSROOM: MGT207**
CHAIRPERSON	Dr. Dima Jamali (DJ)	Chair & Vice-President Academic Affairs	Present
ATTENDEES	Ms. Erin Shea Cadangen (EC)	Assistant, VPAA	Present
	Dr. Habib Fardoun (HF)	Vice-President, Research & Excellence	Apologies
	Dr. Rami El-Khatib (RK)	Dean, Student Affairs	Apologies
	Dr. Kathy O'Sullivan (KO)	Dean, First Year Students	Present
	Dr. Kweh Qian Long (KL)	Dean, Research and Innovation	Present
	Dr. Aseel Takshe (AT)	Acting Dean, FCAS	Present
	Dr. William Smith (WS)	HOD, Communications & Media, FCAS	Present
	Dr. Stefane Mostefa Kabene (SK)	HOD, Social Sciences, FCAS	Apologies
	Dr. Taghreed Masri (TM)	Coordinator, General Education & Language, FCAS	Apologies
	Mr. Massimo Imparato (MI)	Dean, SAID	Present
	Dr. Constantin Spiridonidis (CS)	HOD, Architecture, SAID	Present
	Ms. Sophie Johnson (SJ)	HOD, Interior Design, SAID	Present
	Dr. Sherif Moussa (SM)	Dean, SEAST	Present
	Dr. Syed Zamberi (SZ)	Acting Dean, SOM	Present
	Dr. Davide Contu (DC)	Associate Dean, SOM	Present
	Dr. Rommel Sergio (RS)	Coordinator, BBA in Human Resources Management, SOM	Present
	Dr. Ikhlaas Gurrib (IG)	Coordinator, BBA in Finance & Accounting, SOM	Present

	Dr. Farooq Haq (FH)	Coordinator, BBA in Marketing, Luxury Marketing & International Bu MBA in Marketing, SOM	Present
	Dr. Mohamed Abdelhakim (MA)	Coordinator, BBA in E-Business, MITM, SOM	Present
Administration			
ATTENDEES	Mr. Mohammad Elmoshnib (ME)	Registrar	Present
	Dr. Anwar Abaidullah (AA)	Director, IRP	Present
	Mrs. Menchie Armillo (MA)	Director, LRC	Present
	Mr. Aftab Khan (AK)	Director, ICT	Present

No.	Items	Responsible	Deadline	Completed
1.	**Approval of Agenda** **Motion moved by: Dr. Sherif Moussa** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Kathy O'Sullivan**			
2.	**Approval of Previous Minutes of Meeting dated March 21, 2024** ➢ **Sherif: To change the Head to Chair – Dima: to do it in the new policy.** **Motion moved by: Mr. Massimo Imparato** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Syed Zamberi** **Approval of Previous Minutes of Meeting dated April 4, 2024**			

	➢ **Anwar: New program form was shared and this needs to be used when proposing a new program. This will be shared in IRP shared folder in SharePoint which can be accessed and downloaded.** ➢ **Dr. Dima Jamali requested Dr. Anwar to re-send it again after this meeting.** ➢ **Dr. Dima informed them that there were comments following the last Academic Council Meeting that were highlighted by Dr. Anwar that Dr. Dima forwarded to Dr. Syed to account for in the final DBA program revisions.** **Motion moved by: Dr. Kathy O'Sullivan** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Aseel Takshe**			
3.	**Safety Moment –** Dr. Dima Jamali (DJ) ➢ DJ notified all participants that there were no scheduled safety activities or drills planned for the duration of the meeting, however, in the event of any safety alarms, everyone should proceed according to established procedures. ➢ Dr. Anwar suggested that for our safety moment, whoever is arranging this meeting must contact Junas prior to re-confirm this and then the chair of the committee will announce.	Recorded All present AC members		
4.	**VPAA Office – Dr. Dima Jamali (DJ)** 1. Administrative Teaching Release Proposal (attached) ➢ Dr. Dima had the chance to present this policy in the executive committee meeting to seek their feedback, Dr. Karim recommended that we go exactly with Sharjah University approach. Dr. Dima discussed the proposed credit release for each of the academic administrators if the number students is more than 250. Dr. Dima also mentioned that there is a shift to minimize the stipend at CUD next academic year. Once the new proposal is approved by the senate and BOT, it will be put in action and hopefully people will be prepared, and they know what to expect. **Motion moved by: Dr. Sherif Moussa** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Aseel Takshe**	Recorded All present AC members		

	2. Dynamic Teaching Workload Policy (attached) ➢ Dr. Dima discussed briefly what this policy is about. CUD is moving to a research track next year. It will be very selective; this is for the scholars who are publishing 5-6 solid papers per year. This will apply to a very small minority of faculty. In order to be more inclusive of different faculty and to support young faculty to do research, we are introducing this policy. Anybody who exceed the standard of 2 publications per year, they will be given consideration by their Dean for teaching release the following academic year. If you also see a faculty who has a promise and want to give them space to publish, then they can use this policy proactively but hold them accountable. You can use it proactively or retroactively. Generally, this is applied retroactively. If you want to support a promising faculty and you believe in their potential, make a special request in advance then we will grant them a release and we will hold them accountable. If they are not able to publish, they will go back to a normal workload. This policy is to be used with caution, however, and not to be abused. ➢ Dr. Anwar said to add in the policy: PT / FT ratio should always be maintained as per the standard. **Motion moved by: Mr. Massimo Imparato** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Syed Zamberi** 3. Embracing Teaching Innovations Policy (attached) ➢ Dr. Dima informed that this policy is saying that every CUD faculty member has to introduce an element of innovation and engagement in their classes next year. This is in parallel with an attempt to integrate employability skills and competency goals into the curriculum. Coursera integration in courses is counted here. We are going to be comprehensive and flexible in accounting for what counts as innovation. What we do not want to see is the classical PPT in the classroom where the students will listen passively. This sort of teaching and learning has become obsolete, it is not fair to CUD students and the age in which we live as this is not proper learning. This is mandatory.	Recorded All present AC members		

	➢ Dr. Dima is trying to bring access to Harvard Business School Review material which is very useful. ➢ Dr. Sherif asked Dr. Dima if this assessment is included in the performance evaluation and she responded, definitely yes. ➢ Dr. Dima will give an overview to everything before we come back next academic year, we are prepared to make the new adjustments. ➢ Dr. Farooq asked on how can we monitor this. Dr. Dima said that one way is the syllabus and course files. DJ emphasized about the ERT criticism about our course files. ➢ Dr. Anwar suggested to revise the pedagogy in the course files and to highlight innovative techniques that the faculty are going to use. DJ said that this summer all our syllabi should be revised and harmonized in one template. It would be great to have one template for the entire CUD where the faculty update the pedagogical section and highlight elements of innovation & employability skills that they will introduce in the syllabus. Dr. Anwar is working on the template for the AY 24-25 as this will be complying to CAA standards. Dr. Dima suggested to provide this template before faculty go on break, in a week or two. ➢ Dr. Dima said we agreed that each school will come up with their own set of competency goals or employability skills but we will also propose a set of competency goals for the entire CUD. At least one or two of these competency goals should feature in each syllabus. ➢ Dr. Farooq suggested a class survey question if they find the course to be interactive, engaging and innovative; Dr. Dima agreed and requested Dr. Anwar to add it. **Motion moved by: Dr. Mohamed Abdelhakim** **Motion seconded by: Mr. Massimo Imparato** 4. Faculty Tracks and Assessment Policy (attached) ➢ Dr. Dima explained the outline of 3 tracks (research, teaching & standard) as of next academic that we are creating. ➢ Mr. Massimo asked if we could consider being flexible of moving from one track to another. Dr. Dima said that we need to check this with HR and to see how they will differ when it comes to the contracts to reflect these tracks. It needs to be agreed with the line manager and there will be flexibility. This is being done by in other institutions such as Birmingham	Recorded All present AC members		

	University. The Deans have to make their recommendation to the VPAA and HR and this is reflected in their next contract. For now, when we start the next academic year, most of the faculty will be on the normal standard contracts. If you want to recommend faculty for research and teaching tracks, we have to do it in writing in advance of this semester and notify VPAA and HR for them to make the necessary adjustments. Research track faculty will be released on the teaching side but not completely from service as reflected in the performance evaluation. **Motion moved by: Dr. Syed Zamberi** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Sherif Moussa** 5. Updated Academic Policies (attached) ➢ Dr. Dima said that this policy is purely in light of the ERT visit that we had for the BBA and MBA programs. They have noted that we have to be careful with the faculty qualifications especially those that we put in graduate programs. They have to be research active and solid; they have to be at a certain level. Dr. Dima explained what Dr. Anwar reflected in the policy – qualifications of faculty members (undergraduate and graduate programs). ➢ Dr. Dima discussed what was added to the internship faculty workload allocation and that internship supervision has to be accounted for in the workload of faculty as per CAA standards. ➢ Dr. Syed mentioned that this is not including the doctoral business program. Dr. Dima said that we have a chance to think about it one more time before we approve in the senate. Dr. Dima asked Dr. Syed and Dr. Anwar to sit and update this document to account for the DBA program in SOM. ➢ Dr. Davide asked if this says anything about professor in practice in which Dr. Dima said that they cannot supervise research students. It should be the exception and not the rule as they are very strict about the quality of faculty we put in graduate programs. ➢ Dr. Dima emphasized on the issues of workload, and we have to take it very seriously as we are being scrutinized. We need to monitor workload and overload is also being criticized. Overload can happen at times to meet needs, but it should be an exception and not standard. Never give overload to your junior faculty to give them space to do research.	Recorded All present AC members Recorded		

	➢ Dr. Anwar said that the overload should not be more than 3 credit hours within the academic year. **(Tentative approval subject to the revisions that Dr. Syed and Dr. Anwar will introduce for the DBA program)** **Motion moved by: Dr. Kathy O'Sullivan** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Davide Contu** 6. Performance Evaluation and KPIs (attached) ➢ Dr. Dima discussed the timeline and weightage in the faculty performance evaluation measurement for teaching, research, and community engagement. ➢ Dr. Syed said that maybe we will have in the future internal grants in which Dr. Sherif agreed that we really need to put internal grants. Dr. Dima and Dr. Kweh went to Dr. Karim for the money to be used for internal grants and he said that there is a significant research budget at CUD and to use it the way to want. The same budget can be utilized to support conferences, open access reimbursement, seed money and other research-related expenses. **Motion moved by: Dr. Aseel Takshe** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Sherif Moussa** ➢ Dr. Abdelhakim asked if we are going to assign the same weight to these 3 components. Dr. Dima said that the weights allocated in these 3 tracks will differ from each other based on their KPI. The bulk of the weight is depending on the choice of the track. ➢ Dr. Syed raised that one of the missing things here is the involvement in terms of accreditation. Dr. Dima asked Dr. Kweh asked on how to account on this and Dr. Kweh said that these faculty will get immediately the highest score. Dr. Dima's answer to this is that the research track faculty are not the people who are going to lead the accreditation, it will be either your standard faculty or teaching faculty. In this case, we need to give more percentage to service for standard & teaching. This category is under community	All present AC members Recorded All present AC members		

	engagement (Actively serve on committees at the university, school, or department; specify your contribution) which will have more weight. **Motion moved by: Mr. Massimo Imparato** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Kweh Qian Long** 7. Responsible Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence Tools Policy (attached) ➢ Dr. Dima said that the ministry asked about this; what are we doing in relation to how your students engage with AI. Dr. Dima was asked if we are supporting, prohibiting, or managing and she said we are supporting and trying to manage. They asked on how are we managing, and Dr. Dima said that we have the guidelines and they in the process of getting approved. We embrace and welcome the use of AI in a responsible and ethical way. The ERT team emphasized the element of monitoring and checking. They also said that in every class, we need to do some checking by picking randomly 2-3 students and asking them to do an oral presentation about their submission/project so that it not purely written by AI or ChatGPT and even if they use AI, they have some understanding or contribution to the project. These guidelines will be put in the form of policy, we need to approve them to at least have guidelines for the ethical use of AI by our students and community. ➢ Dr. Dima will revise this before the senate next week to simplify the language. Dr. Anwar asked on what more we can do to monitor the use of AI. Dr. Mohamed said to give more weight to presentation components in project to know who did what. Aftab suggested that the policy will mention that any students who is found guilty abusing the use of AI or any other similar technology will be subject to disciplinary action. ➢ Dr. Aseel said that we have academic integrity policies. Dr. Dima said that we have at CUD a plug-in tool in our system that allows the detection of AI generated content. Dr. Anwar said that our academic integrity policies needs to be slightly reworded in terms of plagiarism. Dr. Anwar will send his suggestion to be put in the policy and send to Dr. Dima. ➢ Menchie said if we can also have IT policy for the security & data privacy and copy right which will capture all. Dr. Dima asked Menchie to write an email on this to be able to follow up on it.	Recorded All present AC members		

	➢ Massimo said the components on how we reconsider our assessment criteria which needs to be evaluated more in the future. Dr. Dima said that another criticism is our assessment which needs to be revisited and it should be more on critical thinking projects and presentations. ➢ Dr. Sherif suggested to refine one paragraph in the policy. Dr. Dima said to include at CUD we will encourage all sorts of presentations that show critical thinking and can detect the use of AI. Oral presentations will be encouraged that can show the contributions of students to the project and the extent to which they have ethically used AI. **(Tentative approval subject to the revisions of Dr. Dima)** **Motion moved by: Dr. Sherif Moussa** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Mohamed Abdelhakim** 8. Guidelines for Professor of Practice (attached) ➢ These will come in when we are having difficulties in hiring expert practitioners. ➢ This guideline can be extended to visiting. ➢ Dr. Anwar emphasized that nonterminal degree holders – approval of the ministry is required before we give them a contract. **Motion moved by: Dr. Syed Zamberi** **Motion seconded by: Mr. Massimo Imparato**			
5	**Research & Innovation – Dr. Kweh Qian Long (KL)** 1. Funding Support of Article Processing Charge Policy (attached) ➢ Dr. Sherif asked about faculty with papers with students' publications. Dr. Kweh said that we have another policy on this. ➢ Dr. Aseel said that if we are limiting the open access, we are also limiting citations. Menchie said that there are categories in open access with associated pay brackets.			

	➢ Dr. Kweh said we will fix it to two as per the standard requirement of publication. Dr. Dima said that anything extra will depend on exception. ➢ Menchie suggested to upload in CUD Institutional Repository. ➢ Dr. Sherif reconfirmed that the cost of this applications will be putting in a different category than the grants in which Dr. Dima said yes. **Motion moved by: Dr. Syed Zamberi** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Mohamed Abdelhakim** 2. Conference Attendance Request (attached) ➢ Dr. Kweh discussed on the changes or updates in eligibility and selection criteria. ➢ Financial Assistance is one of the most asked questions which is reflected in the research policies. (point # 4) 3. Postdoctoral Program Policy (attached) ➢ Dr. Dima said that this policy is about hiring postdocs and the required qualifications. **Motion moved by: Dr. Kathy O'Sullivan** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Sherif Moussa** 4. Research Policies (attached) ➢ Dr. Sherif is suggesting removing the ticket cap and Dr. Aseel said keep it open. ➢ Dr. Dima said to put 2,000 for conference in UAE. ➢ Dr. Anwar reminded that any change in the policy should be kept but struck out and in red color. ➢ Dr. Kweh said that this is about the student's involvement in research at CUD. If the supervisor has some resources such as research grant or he/she is eligible to apply for conference charges, then this policy is applicable.			

	➢ Dr. Kweh asked Dr. Anwar if there is requirement by the ministry for student budget research. Dr. Anwar said that there is no such requirement but only encourages students' involvement in the research. 5. Scientific Publications (attached) ➢ Dr. Dima said this is a guideline for faculty to be very careful where they publish and to check the quality of the journals where they are publishing their scientific articles and to avoid predatory journals. All accreditations agency they require us to have policy on predatory journals that we check our faculty are not publishing and paying money whatever journal as this will hurt the reputation of the institution. **Motion moved by: Dr. Davide Contu** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Farooq Haq**			
6.	**Library – Menchie Armillo (MA)** **1. Library Statistics Report** ➢ Menchie prepared and discussed the comparison for 2022 and 2023 with regards to visits in LRC and group study room bookings. She also discussed on the comparison for borrowing print collections, frequency of databases access. ➢ Menchie said that we have 876 publications archived in our digital repository. ➢ Menchie said that we have an MOU with Amity University for ILL. ➢ Dr. Syed asked on the google scholar. Menchie said that it is not included in the library. Dr. Dima encouraged all faculty to have their account in google scholar.			
7	**Any Other Business** 1. Accommodation **– Mr. Aftab Khan (AK)** ➢ We have secured one building near Burjuman mall with 17 floors and 64 apartments.			

	2. Complaints about time studying before Final Exams **– Mr. Mohammad Elmoshnib (ME)** ➢ We are still debating whether to have additional 1 or 2 days before the final exam however we do not have enough time to add this to our academic calendar. We will think about it to have a solution for this in the near future.			
5.	**<u>Adjournment of meeting</u>** The meeting was adjourned at 01:30 pm.			

CANADIAN UNIVERSITY DUBAI
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ACADEMIC COUNCIL Meeting Minutes			
Tuesday, 11 JUNE 2024		**11:00 pm – 01:00 pm**	**CLASSROOM: HUB113**
CHAIRPERSON	Dr. Dima Jamali (DJ)	Chair & Vice-President Academic Affairs	Present
ATTENDEES	Ms. Erin Shea Cadangen (EC)	Assistant, VPAA	Present
	Dr. Habib Fardoun (HF)	Vice-President, Research & Excellence	Apologies
	Dr. Rami El-Khatib (RK)	Dean, Student Affairs	Apologies
	Dr. Kathy O'Sullivan (KO)	Dean, First Year Students	Present
	Dr. Kweh Qian Long (KL)	Dean, Research and Innovation	Present
	Dr. Aseel Takshe (AT)	Acting Dean, FCAS	Present
	Dr. William Smith (WS)	HOD, Communications & Media, FCAS	Apologies
	Dr. Stefane Mostefa Kabene (SK)	HOD, Social Sciences, FCAS	Apologies
	Dr. Taghreed Masri (TM)	Coordinator, General Education & Language, FCAS	Apologies
	Mr. Massimo Imparato (MI)	Dean, SAID	Present
	Dr. Constantin Spiridonidis (CS)	HOD, Architecture, SAID	Present
	Ms. Sophie Johnson (SJ)	HOD, Interior Design, SAID	Present
	Dr. Sherif Moussa (SM)	Dean, SEAST	Present
	Dr. Syed Zamberi (SZ)	Acting Dean, SOM	Present
	Dr. Davide Contu (DC)	Associate Dean, SOM	Present
	Dr. Rommel Sergio (RS)	Coordinator, BBA in Human Resources Management, SOM	Apologies
	Dr. Ikhlaas Gurrib (IG)	Coordinator, BBA in Finance & Accounting, SOM	Present

	Dr. Farooq Haq (FH)	Coordinator, BBA in Marketing, Luxury Marketing & International Bu MBA in Marketing, SOM	Present
	Dr. Mohamed Abdelhakim (MA)	Coordinator, BBA in E-Business, MITM, SOM	Apologies
	Dr. Soumaya Askri	Coordinator, HRM & Management	Present
	Dr. Tamer Mohamed	Coordinator, Cyber Security	Apologies
	Dr. Rita Zgheib	Coordinator, Computer Science & Software Design	Apologies
	Dr. Gandeva Bayu Satrya	Coordinator, CNET	Apologies
Administration			
ATTENDEES	Mr. Mohammad Elmoshnib (ME)	Registrar	Present
	Dr. Anwar Abaidullah (AA)	Director, IRP	Apologies
	Ms. Carolina Banayat (CB) on behalf of Mrs. Menchie Armillo (MA)	Director, LRC	Present
	Mr. Aftab Khan (AK)	Director, ICT	Present
	Ms. Anum Patel (AP)	Student Council Representative	Present

No.	Items	Responsible	Deadline	Completed
1.	**Approval of Agenda** **Motion moved by: Dr. Sherif Moussa** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Davide Contu**			
2.	**Approval of Previous Minutes of Meeting dated April 29, 2024**			

	Motion moved by: Dr. Kathy O'Sullivan **Motion seconded by: Dr. Syed Zamberi**			
3.	**Safety Moment –** Dr. Dima Jamali (DJ) ➢ DJ notified all participants that there were no scheduled safety activities or drills planned for the duration of the meeting, however, in the event of any safety alarms, everyone should proceed according to established procedures.	Recorded All present AC members		
4.	**FCAS: Public Health – Dr. Aseel Takshe (AT)** 1. MPH Thesis Manual Draft (attached) ➢ Dr. Aseel presented the draft that she created for Public Health as requested by ERT. The manual includes introduction, importance, roles, and guidelines of what the dissertation should look like. This is the first draft that has been prepared for the MPH that we would like to send to the Ministry. ➢ Dr. Dima said that this can be used as a template across different faculties, and we will be circulating this for tweaking to other schools as well. Dr. Syed asked if we should use the word "thesis" versus "dissertation". Usually, thesis is for masters level, and dissertation is for doctorate level. Dr. Dima answered that this is worth considering so that we have uniformity across schools. **Motion moved by: Mr. Massimo Imparato** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Sherif Moussa** 2. Master Manual ENV422: Impacts of Climate Change Policy on Environmental Management: Course Description/CLO/Textbook changes ➢ The syllabus is no longer feasible to be used. They had a look at the CLOs again and they tried to update the CLOs using the same verbs and updated the chapters or the weekly			

	content using the latest readings in climate change. Assignments have been updated hence we need the approval to launch in fall 2024. **Motion moved by: Dr. Kathy O'Sullivan** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Ikhlaas Gurrib**			
5	**Updated Admission and Workload Policies (attached)** – Dr. Dima Jamali (DJ) on behalf of Dr. Anwar **1. Transfer Admission & Transfer Credits Policy** ➢ Minor tweaking on the transfer policies has been done. Dr. Sherif asked about the main changes which are mostly for the graduate level that transfer of credits should not exceed 25%. This is to comply more with the standards based on the recent ERT visit. ➢ Dr. Dima requested all the members to check this policy and be aware of the transfer and admission standards. Elmoshnib asked if this is the increase in number of transfer courses from 6 credits to 9 credits which Massimo confirmed because the majority are above 30 credits in total. Dr. Sherif shared that in one of their requirements received today for the Master of AI, they mentioned that the maximum is 9 credits. 2. **Faculty Workload Policy** ➢ This is more or less the same as per 2019 standards, the only thing here is that summer teaching is not mandatory. We should try as much as possible to complete the faculty load in fall and spring or get approval from the beginning on how to split the faculty load. ➢ Dr. Syed asked that by having this context, are we saying that the study plan cannot include summer and study plan in summer is just optional. Elmoshnib confirmed there is no study plan in summer. Elmoshnib and Dr. Sherif suggested to add more to the paragraph to clarify. Dr. Dima said that we will work on the wording by adding *"Summer teaching is not mandatory **for those who fulfilled their teaching load during fall and spring semester."*** ➢ Dr. Massimo wants some clarity on the thesis credits load in undergraduate graduation project. He said there are 2 ways of delivering the graduation project of undergraduate in SAID. It is either to deliver as a class or in supervision mode. He said that in architecture in particular, we give students the possibility to select different professors. The result becomes a class taught by each of instructor but in terms of load it is 2 credits because it is being divided between faculty members. This concept does not fall under this policy. How they teach in architecture is very much tutorial intense. Massimo said that they have			

	2 options; either they have to change their way of teaching that will have an impact on the quality of the graduation projects, or we have to address the issue because at the moment splitting 6 credits by 3 professors is unfair to the role because of the time they spend in a class. Dr. Dima thinks that this cannot be tailored for each school as this is CUD policy and this is consistent with the UAE education system. Remember that the CUD made big strides to be fairer in accounting for faculty workload. This is not being ignored but it is being recognized but maybe not at the level that faculty aspire to. Dr. Dima asked Massimo to come back next year with a better proposal which we may consider. Dr. Dima said that we need to be careful with workload allocation because they have implications for recruitment and budget. Dr. Massimo then asked that at this stage, at least flag this issue that he addressed for his school. Dr. Dima said to keep it on our radar screen. **Motion moved by: Dr. Aseel Takshe** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Farooq Haq**			
6.	**Syllabus Template (attached) –** Dr. Dima Jamali (DJ) on behalf of Dr. Anwar ➢ Dr. Dima presented the new suggested syllabus template. She emphasized that in teaching pedagogy, we have mentioned key employability skills. Dr. Sherif asked if assessment methodology can be dynamic that we change every semester or is it fixed. Dr. Dima answered that the template is fixed as per ERT requirement to have a uniform template across CUD but the description needs to be updated by the instructor every semester. One of the key comments of the ERT is to diversify assessments. ➢ Mr. Massimo asked about lecture schedules because he feels that if this is fixed, there will not be flexibility for instructors to address their subject in their own ways. Dr. Dima said that this is fixed in the sense that the ERT wanted to see the number of teaching hours covered. This is a key thing that they insisted on. We are suggesting the structure to ensure that we cover the number of weeks that we need to cover. Dr. Dima said that the content is always something that we will update. Mr. Massimo reconfirmed that it means we show the students a different weekly schedule. ➢ Dr. Constantin mentioned that it is also related to the evaluation process because when we make the evaluation, and we see that some of the CLOs for example were not properly covered and we have to take some additional measures, so we necessarily adapt. This is not			

	just an option but a necessity. Dr. Dima said that these things need to be updated almost on a yearly basis, but we need to track what we change and to report it. ➢ Dr. Dima said that this syllabus is quite comprehensive as a template. Every year, you need to make your tweaking/updates within because even the material in classrooms needs to be updated and reported on that while keeping the balance of PLO's and CLO's. The AC needs to be informed of any major changes. Program level changes go to the Ministry while course level changes do not go the Ministry, but we need to keep track of them internally. ➢ Dr. Syed mentioned the integration of Coursera. According to Dr. Anwar, we need to be very careful on this aspect because currently we do not have a policy. Dr. Dima disagreed because you are free in your assessment and the Ministry is saying to diversify your assessment. Secondly, Dr. Anwar said that Coursera is an external assessment that we are bringing into our own assessment. Dr. Dima said that this is only one component out of the whole. It is not the only way that we are assessing the students, we are giving it 20%. Dr. Syed said that this is the concern raised which he is highlighting to this session to have a clear direction about this. Dr. Dima to talk to Dr. Anwar. ➢ Dr. Dima reminded all members to pass this on as early as possible to their faculty so they can start doing these updates in summer so that when we start the new semester, we are all using the new template syllabus. **Motion moved by: Dr. Kweh Qian Long** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Sherif Moussa**			
7	**Program Effectiveness Report Template (attached) –** Dr. Sherif Moussa (SM) on behalf of Dr. Anwar ➢ Dr. Sherif mentioned that this a requirement by all the committee that comes from the Ministry. We need to have some program effectiveness every year to assess the programs properly and to close the loop next year. All data are to be reflected in here. ➢ Dr. Dima said that this a very important step forward, this is a way to keep track on what is happening in our programs and how they are improving every year. Majority of the data on CLO and PLO can be provided or filled in but the faculty at program level and the program coordinator need to write the narrative. The most important part is status of remedial action plan of previous year because what the ministry wants to see is a process of closing the loop and continuously improving our programs.			

	➢ Dr. Constantin wanted to clarify what would be the basis of the evaluation of the program at the end. If some of the PLOs were not properly achieved, do we calculate them based on the number of the students or the percentage. Dr. Sherif said that IRP will decide on this. Another question from Dr. Constantin was how to define the benchmark. He said that if we do not define the weight of the CLO in the different assessment processes then we can have a very much successful PLO but they have a very little contribution in the final profile of the outcome because this is which is related to the quality of the program. Dr. Dima said that this needs to be discussed with IRP. ➢ Dr. Syed asked can they for example add a basket of courses to map to the PLO. He said that usually we need to have the equal courses mapping to that particular PLO. Dr. Sherif said that it doesn't have to. Dr. Syed acknowledged that we should go back to AOL committee at a school level to decide this. Dr. Dima answered that there is no formula, we are offering a template. You have to decide on how you are using it. Example is, put the CLO of the MBA, you put the courses of the MBA and you do the mapping. If you want to do further tweaking, discuss it in your AOL and come back to inform the AC. **Motion moved by: Dr. Kathy O'Sullivan** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Syed Zamberi**			
8	**Ethics Approval Certificate (attached)** – Dr. Kweh Qian Long (KL) ➢ Dr. Kweh started by saying that this is about when you are doing research related to human subject, human interaction, human testing, animal testing, social values and clinical values. We may have IRB in which they will check the questionnaires whether it is harmful to human subject or not. If all is clear, then this notice will be presented to faculty so they can submit alongside their research paper for potential publication. With this notice, you can have a higher chance of publishing the research paper in a top journal. ➢ Dr. Dima said it is best practice and it protects the institution. The custodian is Dr. Kweh and the research committee. ➢ Dr. Farooq asked on the foreseen challenges in this form. Dr. Kweh said in the existing policy there is another form that needs to be filled regarding this. This is just the cover form. ➢ Dr. Syed suggested adding in the type of research to make it clearer for data collection in the future to keep track.			

	Motion moved by: Dr. Aseel Takshe **Motion seconded by: Dr. Farooq Haq**			
9	**Updated KPIs for Deans and HODs (attached)** – Dr. Dima Jamali (DJ) ➢ Dr. Dima worked on an initial draft which she wanted to run it by the AC. She explained the key areas that we will be looking at. • To adjust the target to 70% on employability rate. • The target for each objective for research outcomes needs to be refined. • Dr. Constantin said that it must be clear if the mark refers to the encouragement or the outcome. • Dr. Sherif suggested that there should be a KPI relating to budget efficiency and optimization. • Dr. Kweh emphasized on the employability rate is also 5% of QS – Dr. Dima said that we need to keep it there and start thinking and work with Dr. Anwar to have our own employability survey per school. ➢ Sophie asked if that is just for the Deans or for the Heads as well. Dr. Dima said it is more or less domains but have different weights but it is not ready.			
10.	**Update on RPL Policy (attached)** – Dr. Sherif Moussa (SM) ➢ We have the RPL policy, but we need to tweak it to be in compliance with the new standards. Dr. Sherif explained the changes made in this policy. He emphasized that a challenge exam is a must because today we got a requirement from the Ministry to have this. This policy is to facilitate recognizing prior learning that has been done outside of CUD which may be formal or informal. ➢ Elmoshnib explained further on how the challenge exam works by providing a proper example. Dr. Dima said that if somebody has significant prior learning that they want CUD to recognize, there is a committee, they will meet and vet the document, and the applicant must sit for a challenge exam. They may have their prior learning recognized or not. Elmoshnib said that the challenge exam of the course should cover the major learning outcomes of the course. He said that other institutes are dealing with it by not waiving the			

	credits, but they give exemption for the course and the student has to take another elective course. Dr. Constantin asked if it can be oral. Elmoshnib answered that it can but depending on the case. Dr. Dima asked how many cases we are going to get on this which Elmoshnib said that there will be a lot hence he suggested to restrict to level 1 or level 2 courses. Dr. Sherif then said to keep this decision to the academic side. **Motion moved by: Dr. Soumiya Askri** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Kweh Qian Long**			
11.	**Approval of SEAST Curriculum changes** – Dr. Sherif Moussa (SM) ➢ Dr. Sherif presented the summary of their curriculum meeting and the changes that they have discussed. They have 3 courses that are similar in content and CLOs but having different names. They have unified these courses and have a new code and new course name which needs to be approved so they can implement in the study plan. Elmoshnib will have a meeting with SEAST to agree on the codes. **Motion moved by: Dr. Aseel Takshe** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Constantin Spyridonidis** ➢ SEAST is planning to launch the masters of cybersecurity next year and to get started, the AC approval is needed on the program structure. Dr. Dima asked why we have digital forensics where cybersecurity is more attractive. Dr. Dima said we need to be careful in using the word “forensics” as it will have limited appeal based on prior experience. **Motion moved by: Dr. Constantin Spyridonidis** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Soumiya Askri** ➢ Adding Lab component to the course Artificial Intelligence BCS405 **Motion moved by: Dr. Soumiya Askri** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Kiran Tangri**			

	➢ Changing the name of the course Introduction to Computer Science I (BCS102) **Motion moved by: Dr. Kathy O'Sullivan** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Ikhlaas Gurrib** ➢ Changing the CLO for the course MEC310 Mechatronics Engineering **Motion moved by: Dr. Farooq Haq** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Constantin Spyridonidis** ➢ Changing the CLO for the course MEC422 Mechatronics System Design **Motion moved by: Dr. Aseel Takshe** **Motion seconded by: Ms. Sophie Johnson**			
12	**Library** – Carolina Banayat ➢ **Fall 2024 course resources** • Carolina sent the list yesterday of course resources that are not available in the library for acquisition. These are based on the course list from the schedule received from registration. The members are being requested to review the email to inform the library on the correct courses to be offered this fall to recheck the collections that are available in the library and the resources that are not available in our collection will be discussed in the LRC committee meeting on Thursday for approval for acquisition. In the list, some of the course materials are very outdated. If the members have suggestions to replace them, they need to please send to Library. Dr. Dima said that as Deans and Heads, they have a responsibility to check these materials if it is outdated and the faculty is required to update their course materials and to start thinking about the innovations that they want to introduce. Updating and using the latest edition is a MUST. ➢ **Termination of Oxford Clinical Psychology Database**			

	• The content of the database is very limited to neuropsychology and neuroscience. ➢ **Trial Access for Databases for Psychology** • In replacement of the point above, they have requested the trial access. Currently we have a running trial database access for psychology. We have requested 3 databases under EBSCO – PsycNET, PsycArticle and PsycBook. This is now uploaded in the library website under trial access tab. ➢ **Subscription for SAID Databases** • Library had a trial run for Bloomsbury Design Library and Fairchild collection database. They have received feedback from the department of architecture that they would like to subscribe to this database. They will be subscribing in these databases in replacement of Oxford Group Art Online.			
13	**Any Other Business** 1. **Registration** – Mr. Mohammad Elmoshnib (ME) ➢ **LNG Course code change (101, 102, 103)** • Elmoshnib will try to unify the codes to be consistent with other course codes. • He further asked if there is any significant difference between LNG in each schools, do we need this segregation or not in which Dr. Kathy answered that no we don't. ➢ **Written Final Exams, Courses with no final exams.** • Elmoshnib received several requests in the last couple of semesters about courses not having a final exam but upon checking the syllabus, there is a requirement of final exam. Elmoshnib needs to systemize this, and he is requesting that the IRP with the Deans to have a full review of all the offered courses and provide registration department with a table mentioning the course code, course name and identifying if there a final exam or not. Dr. Dima asked Elmoshnib to do this exercise every semester. For him to request from the Deans a table summary when they prepare the schedule. For courses that do not have a Final Exam, the Deans need to inform			

	Elmoshnib in advance. Elmoshnib further suggested to add a column in the class schedule report subject to the verification of the Deans. ➢ **Grade Submission – Errors** • Registration received significant cases this semester especially from PT Faculty did a massive error in grade submission. This is due to not having a proper training and monitoring. Dr. Dima said that there should be an orientation for PT Faculty and a mentoring system. We need to guide them so they can deliver on their job properly. Every Dean needs to scrutinize and vet all PT faculty that they want to hire and assign a mentor as soon as they join. • Another case is that the new FT Faculty have entered the grades wrongly. Registration developed a grade submission report for chairs and HODs, where they will know at which stage the faculty did not submit their report and they just need to regularly check this report. Elmoshnib also highlighted that if there is any error with the calculation and system entry done by the faculty, it will be flagged and should not be approved. Elmoshnib will visit the Deans with ICT to give an orientation and provide training about the report. ➢ **Fall Registration and Summer Availability** • Elmoshnib said we need to make sure that we have somebody responsible in every school during the summer specifically that we are receiving so many inquiries about the programs. He said that every school or department to elect some names to be available online or on campus as a point of contact during summer who they can refer to about queries regarding the program and special cases and who will be covering the department to make sure the school is represented in summer. Dr. Dima added that we need to do the same for some key faculty and put a schedule in place for summer, the same we did for the Deans and identify a period when some faculty are present so that we are not completely absent. Elmoshnib said he only needs to receive the feedback or instruction from the faculty, and they will get back			

	to the students accordingly. Dr. Dima asked the Deans to survey their faculty quickly and get back to Elmoshnib. **2. Updated on Entrepreneurship Courses –** Dr. Kiran Tangri (KT) • They have made minor changes in the 4 courses in Entrepreneurship (ENT 141, ENT 142, ENT 241 & ENT 242) in way of introducing important updates, making the courses more hands on & experiential and embed the students into the entrepreneurial ecosystem around them so they have a good experience, and they are prepared to enter the market as entrepreneurs. They have updated the contents of the program and removed redundancies as per the ERT feedback. **Motion moved by: Dr. Soumiya Askri** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Syed Zamberi**			
5.	**<u>Adjournment of meeting</u>** The meeting was adjourned at 01:02 pm.			

CANADIAN UNIVERSITY DUBAI
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Academic Committee Meeting Minutes			
Thursday, 03 OCTOBER 2024		**12:00 pm – 02:00 pm**	**CLASSROOM: MGT106**
CHAIRPERSON	Dr. Adam Lawrence Fenech (AF)	Chair & Provost	Present
ATTENDEES	Ms. Pari Shamsi (PS)	Executive Assistant to the Provost	Present
	Dr. Sherif Moussa (SM)	Dean, SEAST	Present
	Mr. Massimo Imparato (MI)	Dean, SAID	Present
	Dr. Aseel Takshe (AT)	Dean, SEHS	Present
	Dr. Evangelos Moustakas (EM)	Dean, SCMS and SCI	Present
	Dr. Timothy Richard Jordan (TRJ)	Acting Dean, Psychology	Apologies
	Dr. Martin Spraggon Hernandez (MSH)	Dean, SOM	Present
	Dr. Robert McClung (RM)	Dean – First Year Students	Present
	Dr. Kweh Qian Long (KQL)	Dean of Research and Innovation	Present
	Dr. Gandeva Bayu Satrya (GBS)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of CNET	Present
	Dr. Rita Zgheib (RZ)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of Computer Science	Present
	Dr. Tamer Mohamed Abdellatif Mohamed (TMAM)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of Cyber Security	Present
	Dr. Ahmed Al Gindy	Associate Professor and Program Coordinator of Electrical Engineering	Present
	Dr. Constantin Victor Spiridonidis (CVS)	Professor and Head of Dept, Architecture	Present
	Ms. Sophie Johnson (SJ)	Senior Lecturer and Head of Dept, Interior Design	Present
	Dr. Rima Mishlawi (RM)	Associate Professor and Acting Associate Dean (Program Coordinator of MBA)	Present

	Dr. Ibrahim Tabche (IT)	Associate Professor and Acting Associate Dean – UG programs and Program Coordinator of IB and HRM	Present
	Dr. Avraam Papasthathopolos (AP)	Associate Professor and Chair of AACSB Committee	Present
	Dr. Farooq Haq (FH)	Professor and Program Coordinator of MKT	Present
	Dr. Ikhlaas Gurrib (IG)	Professor and Program Coordinator of Finance	Present
	Dr. Saida Harguem (SH)	Associate Professor and Program Coordinator of E-Business and MIT	Present
	Mr. Mohammad Elmoshnib (ME)	Registrar	Present
	Mr. Wajahat Ullah Khan (WUK) on behalf of Dr. Anwar Abaidullah (AA)	Director, IRP	Present
	Mrs. Menchie Armillo (MA)	Director, LRC	Present
	Mr. Aftab Khan (AK)	Director, ICT	Present
	Dr. Rami El Khattib (RK)	Vice President Student Services	Present
	Ms. Shaima Alhai	Student Council President	Present
INVITEES	Mr. Junos Andrino (JA)	HSE/Facilities Officer	Present
	Ms. May El Khoury (MEK)	Career Services and Internship Coordinator	Present
	Dr. Sahar Issa	Associate Professor, SEHS	Present

No.	Items	Responsible	Deadline	Completed
1.	**Approval of Agenda** **Motion moved by: Dr. Ibrahim Tabche** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Robert McClung**			

2.	**Approval of Previous Minutes of Meeting dated June 11, 2024** **Motion moved by: Dr. Sherif Moussa** **Motion seconded by: Dr. Evangelos Moustakas**			
3.	**Safety Moment** ➢ As advised by the CAA, depending on the category, meetings need to begin with a safety moment to: • Enhance emergency response capabilities • Improve safety awareness amongst staff and students • To ensure better compliance with safety regulations ➢ The newly appointed and certified fire wardens and first aiders were announced to the committee • A special thanks was conveyed to the deans and department heads for selected representatives to attend the training and be certified. ➢ Recognition was extended to the Safety Corner created in the Architecture Labs consisting of: • Emergency contact numbers • Laboratory manuals • Safety contacts • All other departments are encouraged to implement the same safety corner within their respected departments. ➢ Risk assessment audit was completed in the biology, chemistry and preparation laboratories. The audit report was submitted to the CAA. ➢ CUD is an active member of a safety networking establishment called Emirates Higher-Ed Safety Professional Network (EHSPN). • CUD was represented by the dean of school of environmental Health sciences and other faculty members in the public health. ➢ A total of 10 government regulatory visits were conducted. • 5 from the ministry of education • 3 from Dubai civil defense • 1 from Dubai municipality	Recorded All present AC members		

	• 1 from ministry of health • All inspections were passed ➢ The emergency exits in the SOM building were announced to the members. • Pest contract and fire maintenance is expected to be conducted on October 4, 2024. ➢ An unannounced fire drill is expected to be conducted in the SOM building by the end of 2024. • This drill will also include the participation of Dubai Civil Defense authority, Dubai police and ambulance paramedics.			
4.	**Finalizing the implementation of Mandatory Internship Preparation Sessions** It was mandated by the Ministry of Education to have an Orientation workshop conducted for internships. Workshops are already implemented to prepare students for the job market however as attendance is not mandatory it has resulted in low engagement. It was decided to implement a 3-day mandatory session consisting of Orientation, workshops and mock interview sessions as a preparation course to ensure student readiness in the job market which was approved by the ministry in Spring semester of AY 2023/24. To ensure a successful participation, student affairs has proposed to implement this in the CAMS system allowing students to look at these sessions as a course. When a student gains a number of credit hours, the system would mandate them to then attend the 3-day session a year before starting their internship. ➢ It was requested that all members of the academic committee discuss internally within their departments for any alternative solutions that can ensure a success rate of 100% participation. • A follow up in depth discussion is to be conducted in the next academic committee meeting.	Recorded All present AC members	Next AC meeting	

	➢ Emphasis was made on the Orientation session being mandatory while the other 2 workshops are offered by the Career services and internship office at CUD for the betterment of the student experience.			
5	**Student Registration Statistics (Fall 2024-25)** A presentation as conducted to provide descriptive information on the student numbers per school and preparations for the next steps impacting the Spring semester. **Student Enrollment** Overall general student figures per school ➢ CUD has 3055 students registered in the current Fall semester of AY 2024/25, broken down as follows: • 812 new students • 2243 returning students. ➢ The general figures were presented per selected school to identify those students who may change their major, not meet admission requirements or drop out post the first semester. • Special acknowledgement was made to the Dean of First Year Students whose role will offer extensive support in the retention and advising of first years. Overall student real figures ➢ Upon isolating the first-year students which is currently 761 students, the difference of 51 students is identified to be in the graduate school. • With this, a breakdown of actual student numbers per school was presented to the committee. ➢ School of management (UG)has a total of 790 students registered. • 3 programs were identified as phasing out programs with low number of registered students waiting to finish their graduation requirements: ○ Events and Tourism Management ○ Luxury Marketing ○ Sports Management • International Business Program is the highest in demand with 345 students enrolled. ➢ School of management – graduate studies have a total of 180 students registered.	Recorded		

	• 153 students in MBA and 27 in MIT ➢ School of Engineering, Applied Science and Technology has 425 students registered. • The BSc in Electrical Engineering – Electronics program is identified as phasing out. • The Computer Science program is the highest in demand with 144 students enrolled. ➢ School of Architecture and Interior Design has a total of 155 students registered. • 100 students in Architecture and 55 in Interior Design. ➢ School of Communication and Media Studies has a total of 302 students registered • Advertising and Journalism are programs phasing out • The public relations program has the highest enrollment of 174 students. ➢ School of Creative Industries has a total of 105 students registered. • The school has 3 specializations. 50 students are enrolled in the Media Business and Communication specialization. ➢ School of Public health has a total of 99 students registered • The highest enrollment is in the program of Environmental Health Management Health Sciences with 59 students. ➢ School of Psychology and Applied Sociology has a total of 238 students registered • Applied sociology (Arabic) is a program phasing out <u>Canadian Students Figures</u> ➢ Out of 81 new students, 26 of which have been identified as Canadian ➢ Out of 1,112 returning students, 55 of which have been identified as Canadian. <u>Drop out Sheet</u> ➢ Drop out rate has been calculated in varies way keeping in consideration – Y2Y, Semester to Semester, Financial or Program drop out. • As mandated by the ministry of education, any student transferring to Canada should not be considered a drop out but rather a success rate as transfer to Canada is one of our KPIs – to create the portal and bridge to Canada. Thus, transfer to Canada students is not included in CUD's drop out rate. ➢ Each Dean will be advised of their school's dropout rate in separate one on one meetings for further discussion and action planning.			

	<u>Academic probations</u> ➢ There are currently 316 students that are under academic probations. • As mandated by the ministry, students with a GPA <2 for 3 consecutive semesters shall be dismissed from the program. • This is an important factor that reflects in the dropout rate. • Importance and emphasis were placed on academic advising specifically for these students. <u>Expected to graduate students</u> ➢ The registrar's office has projected that 505 students are expected to graduate by the end of AY 2024/25. This projected number excludes the Fall graduates. ➢ Deans were requested to disseminate the information to the academic advisors to check these student records and advise all relevant parties in regard to the course offerings in the upcoming Spring and Summer semesters. ➢ It is recommended that every advisor follows the below steps: • Review the student transcript against the study plan • Confirm which courses need to be offered in Spring and/or Summer. • Advise on any special arrangements if needed • Communicate the requirements to the school dean and registration office • Based on the requirements, deans can confirm their manpower plan and budget against Part Time Faculty hiring and teaching load. <u>Important dates</u> ➢ The university is currently in week 6 of the semester and in week 8 midterms will begin. ➢ Advisors are requested to complete the graduation progression form for expected graduates in the 2 weeks prior to midterms. ➢ In week 10, that is, October 31st, 2024, pre-registration will open for Spring semester where all students will be eligible to register without any academic advising. • Academic advising is only during the registration week. ➢ By October 30th, 2024, the final exam schedule for Fall semester will be announced.			

6.	**New Syllabus Template Implementation (Follow Up)** IRP shared the new template through SharePoint accessible to all deans. ➢ SEAST is adapting the new template for this semester. • It was agreed with the IRP that the change will be made gradually between the Fall and Spring semester of AY 2024/25. ➢ SAID already transferred the syllabi into the new template. Pending items are the course files which is in the plan to be transferred in the new templates. ➢ SOM recently had all their syllabi approved by the CAA and are now in the process of re-updating the same in the new template for the next semester (Spring). ➢ SCMS and SCI is working on this and should be completed by next semester (Spring). ➢ SEHS has completed the task.	Recorded	-	-
7	**Policy Updates** <u>Examination Quality Review and Moderation Policy</u> The policy is being amended under Procedure, clause 1 to state the following: ***The moderator shall select a sufficient number, but not less than five (05), of the total answer scripts of assessments marked by the course faculty (representative of High, Medium, and Low marks) and determine whether the sampled scripts have been marked consistently, accurately, and fairly.*** ➢ Following a series of discussions, the deans unanimously agreed that the number should be amend to state not less than six (6). <u>Academic Progress Policy</u> The policy is being amended to include a section of student appeal, stating the following: ***Right to Appeal*** ***Submission of Appeal*** ***The student must submit a written appeal to the Dean of the School/Faculty within ten (10) business days from the date of the dismissal notification. The appeal must include:*** • ***A detailed letter outlining the reasons for the appeal, including any extenuating circumstances or new evidence that may have affected their academic performance.***	Recorded	-	-

	• *Supporting documents such as medical certificates, counseling records, or any other relevant documentation.* *Review of Appeal* • *Upon receipt of the appeal, the Dean will acknowledge the appeal in writing within five (5) business days.* • *The Dean shall convene an Appeals Committee consisting of a faculty members, representative from admission and registration department, and a representative of Student Affairs office.* • *The Appeals Committee shall review the student's academic record, the appeal letter, and any supporting documentation. They may also request a meeting with the student for further clarification.* *Decision* • *The Appeals Committee will make a recommendation to the Registrar within ten (10) business days of receiving the appeal.* • *The Registrar will make a final decision based on the committee's recommendation and will notify the student in writing within five (5) business days of the committee's recommendation.* • *The decision of the Registrar is final and binding. Should the decision be in favor of the applicant, the applicant will be admitted to his/her chosen program or an alternative should no place be available in his/her chosen program.* *Reinstatement* • *If the appeal is successful, the student will be reinstated in the program and placed on a strict academic plan developed in consultation with their academic advisor.* • *The student must comply with all conditions outlined in the academic plan to continue in the program.* *Records* *All documentation related to the appeal, including the student's appeal letter, supporting documents, and the final decision, will be maintained in the student's academic file in the Registrar's Office.*			

	Student Assessment and Grading Policy This policy is being amended in the sections: Purpose, Scope and Policy statements – A. Assessment to include the following: ***Purpose*** ***The Policy on Student Assessment and Grading aims to establish clear and consistent guidelines for evaluating student performance at CUD. It ensures that assessments are fair, transparent, and aligned with course and program learning outcomes. The policy also upholds academic integrity, provides criteria for grading, and ensures timely, constructive feedback to support student success.*** ***Scope*** ***This policy applies to all undergraduate and graduate programs at CUD. It covers all forms of student assessments, including but not limited to exams, assignments, projects, presentations, and participation. The policy applies to faculty members responsible for designing and grading assessments, academic administrators involved in moderation and quality assurance, and students subject to these assessments. It also includes procedures for addressing grievances related to assessment and grading and guidelines for maintaining academic records.*** ***Policy Statements*** ***Assessment*** ***Variety of Assessment Tools: Faculty must utilize a variety of appropriate assessment tools to ensure that students achieve the specified knowledge, skills, and competencies outlined in the course, unit, or module. These assessments should be designed to comprehensively evaluate students' understanding and performance in relation to the learning outcomes.*** ***Validity and Alignment: All assessment tools must be valid and appropriately aligned with the course learning outcomes and the level of the course. Faculty are responsible for ensuring that***			

	assessments accurately measure the intended learning outcomes and are suitable for the level of study. ***Development and Implementation of Rubrics or Marking Scheme: Rubrics must be developed and implemented for all assessment tools to clearly outline the criteria and standards for evaluating student work. They should be detailed and transparent, providing students with a clear understanding of how their performance will be assessed.*** ***If rubrics are not suitable for a particular assessment, a detailed marking scheme must be used instead. The marking scheme should clearly outline the criteria and guidelines for awarding marks to ensure that assessment remains fair and transparent.*** ***Moderation and Independent Evaluation: Methods for moderation and assessment must include processes where more than one individual independently marks or moderates an assessment to ensure fairness and consistency in grading, as well as to provide a mechanism for resolving discrepancies in evaluations. (Refer to 3.x Examination Quality Review and Moderation Policy (EQRMP)).*** ***Authentication of Students' Work: Methods for authenticating students' work must be implemented to verify that the submitted work is the student's own, including techniques such as plagiarism detection tools, in-class presentations, or oral examinations. (Refer to 6.w Student Academic Integrity Policy (SAIP)).*** ***Guidance on Assessment Methodologies: Clear, written guidance must be provided for faculty, staff, and students on assessment methodologies, tools, and grading practices to ensure comparability of academic standards and consistency with teaching, learning, and assessment approaches across the institution.*** ***Appropriateness of Assessment Methodologies: Assessment methodologies must be appropriate for the program and course's nature, level, content, and mode of delivery, and should be designed to effectively demonstrate the achievement of the learning outcomes.*** <u>Student Study Mode and Load Policy</u>			

	This information already existed in the university catalogue, but it was mandated by the Ministry of Education to have it in the form of a policy. The same information has been extracted and formatted in the form of a policy. No amendments are made. **The motion to approve the policy updates for 'Examination Quality Review and Moderation Policy' 'Academic Progress Policy' 'Student Assessment and Grading Policy' and approve the new policy of 'Student Study Mode and Load Policy' was moved by SM and seconded by AAG.** **The motion to approve the policy updates and the new policy was unanimously approved by all present academic committee members.**			
8	**Stipulation 3.10.3: develop and implement rubrics for all assessment tools** Referring to the proposal of amendment in the Student Assessment and Grading policy emphasis was made on the development and implementation of rubrics or marking scheme. ➢ Rubrics must be implemented for all assessments. ➢ Rubrics are applicable for assignments and projects. ➢ If rubrics are not suitable for a type of assessment such as quiz, then a detailed marking scheme must be implemented.	Recorded	-	-
9	**Approval of curriculum changes for CECS department** The school presented the proposed changes in the curriculum of the computer engineering and computational sciences programs. ➢ A total of 6 courses were upgraded • NET105: missing weight grade in the midterm. • NET120: Changed the order of weekly topics and changed lab components • NET320: Updated CLOs, changed order of weekly topics and changed lab components • NET303 and NET220: Updated the syllabus by updating weekly labs. • BCS221: Updated two (2) labs. ➢ All these courses are 2+2 **Motion to approve the changes in the CECS curriculum was moved by MI and seconded by KQL.**	Recorded	-	-

	The changes in the CECS curriculum were unanimously approved by all present academic committee members.			
10.	**New concentrations for BSc in Mechatronics** In the department of Electrical Engineering, the program of Mechatronics has been successful. However, in the last two (2) years, the program faced a decline and feedback from stakeholders requested to include more AI components. Thus, the school has decided to rebrand this program to make it more attractive as follows: ➢ Submit substantive change requests to the CAA to keep the core specifications of the program and two (2) new concentrations in: • Robotics Artificial Intelligence • Industrial Management ➢ The current program has 138 credit hours and with the new proposal the credit hours is 137. ➢ For the concentration of Robotics Artificial Intelligence, the introduction of below five (5) core courses are proposed: • RAI471 Robotics • RAI472 Computer Vision • RAI481 Machine Learning for Robotics • RAI482 Computational Intelligence • RAI483 Vehicle Automation Systems ➢ For the concentration of Industrial Management, the introduction of below five (5) core courses are proposed: • IDM471 Production Management for Engineers • IDM472 Smart Manufacturing Systems • IDM481 Smart Supply Chain Management • IDM482 Production Planning and Control • IDM483 Industrial Safety and Risk Management ➢ Four (4) electives are also introduced for both concentrations as follows: • Artificial Intelligence Ethics • Human Robotics Interactions • Data Analytics for Industrial Engineers	Recorded	-	-

	• Technology and Innovation Management ➢ The proposed changes align with the ABET accreditation requirements of: • Mathematics and Basic Science courses of 30 credit hours • General Education courses of 21 credit hours • Engineering and Mechatronics core courses 28+21 which is 49 credits while ABET only needs 45 • Internship/Graduation projects of 7 credits • Robotics and AI concentration of 15 credits as per the CAA • Industrial Management concentration of 15 credits as per the CAA ➢ *It was identified that a course named Technology and Innovation Management already exists in the new MBA program study plan which was approved by the CAA.* ➢ *SEAST will need to rename this elective course.* ➢ *It was agreed by all schools to introduce electives that can be shared amongst all schools to appeal to all students.* **Motion to approve the changes in the Mechatronics program to include two (2) concentrations was moved by IT and seconded by CVS.** **The motion to approve the inclusion of two (2) concentrations in the Mechatronics program was unanimously approved by all present academic committee members.**			
11.	**Approval of changes in courses Creative Industries and Communication and Media courses** Changes are proposed in the mentioned courses of Creative Industries program and Communication and Media programs to include the following: ➢ Courses were revamped as they were outdated • Communications core textbooks were from 17 years ago and reference resources were out of date. ➢ Assessments were updated where applicable • From quiz to presentations • In some cases, the final exam has been replaced with coursework due to the nature of the course. ➢ Proposed to make the courses more practical.	Recorded	-	-

	➢ The curriculum changes approval form was shared with the academic committee members and previously shared with IRP ➢ Some courses do require labs and major changes need to be made but this will be implemented before the next accreditation **Motion to approve the minor changes in the course curriculum of Creative Industries and Communication and Media courses was moved by SM and seconded by MI.** **Motion to approve the minor changes in the course curriculum of Creative Industries and Communication and Media courses was unanimously approved by all present academic committee members.**			
12	**Change in Incomplete grades policy – duration** As per the current incomplete policy, a student has 12 months to complete their incomplete. The SOM proposed the best practice of reducing this to 1 semester for the following reasons: ➢ To give accountability and responsibility to students to be timely in completing their work ➢ Knowledge can become obsolete, and we must be agile ➢ Requires a lot of effort from an admin point of view to keep track of the burden of paperwork of one incomplete for a whole year. ➢ *MSH is to draft an amendment to the policy in the next academic committee meeting, while ensuring exceptional cases are included in the draft*	Recorded MSH to draft the policy amendment	Next AC meeting	-
13.	**<u>Adjournment of meeting</u>** The meeting was adjourned at 14:00 pm.			

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Academic Committee Meeting Minutes			
Wednesday, November 20th, 2024	**13:40 pm – 15:00 pm**		**CLASSROOM: MGT106**
CHAIRPERSON	Dr. Adam Lawrence Fenech (AF)	Chair & Provost	Present
ATTENDEES	Ms. Pari Shamsi (PS)	Executive Assistant to the Provost	Present
	Dr. Sherif Moussa (SM)	Dean, SEAST	Present
	Mr. Massimo Imparato (MI)	Dean, SAID	Present
	Dr. Aseel Takshe (AT)	Dean, SEHS	Present
	Dr. Evangelos Moustakas (EM)	Dean, SCMS and SCI	Present
	Dr. Timothy Richard Jordan (TRJ)	Acting Dean, Psychology	Apologies
	Dr. Martin Spraggon Hernandez (MSH)	Dean, SOM	Present
	Dr. Robert McClung (RM)	Dean – First Year Students	Apologies
	Dr. Kweh Qian Long (KQL)	Dean of Research and Innovation	Present
	Dr. Gandeva Bayu Satrya (GBS)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of CNET	Present
	Dr. Rita Zgheib (RZ)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of Computer Science	Apologies
	Dr. Tamer Mohamed Abdellatif Mohamed (TMAM)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of Cyber Security	Apologies
	Dr. Ahmed Al Gindy	Associate Professor and Program Coordinator of Electrical Engineering	Present
	Dr. Constantin Victor Spiridonidis (CVS)	Professor and Head of Dept, Architecture	Present
	Ms. Sophie Johnson (SJ)	Senior Lecturer and Head of Dept, Interior Design	Present
	Dr. Rima Mishlawi (RM)	Associate Professor and Acting Associate Dean (Program Coordinator of MBA)	Apologies

	Dr. Ibrahim Tabche (IT)	Associate Professor and Acting Associate Dean – UG programs and Program Coordinator of IB and HRM	Present
	Dr. Farooq Haq (FH)	Professor and Program Coordinator of MKT	Present
	Dr. Ikhlaas Gurrib (IG)	Professor and Program Coordinator of Finance	Present
	Dr. Saida Harguem (SH)	Associate Professor and Program Coordinator of E-Business and MIT	Present
	Mr. Mohammad Elmoshnib (ME)	Registrar	Present
	Dr. Anwar Abaidullah (AA)	Dean, IRP	Present
	Mrs. Menchie Armillo (MA)	Director, LRC	Present
	Mr. Aftab Khan (AK)	Director, ICT	Present
	Dr. Rami El Khattib (RK)	Vice President Student Services	Apologies
	Ms. Shaima Alhai	Student Council President	Present
INVITEES	Mr. Junos Andrino (JA)	HSE/Facilities Officer	Present
	Ms. May El Khoury (MEK)	Career Services and Internship Coordinator	Apologies
	Ms. Eva Allouche (EA) on behalf of Dr. Rami El Khatib (RK)	Communication Manager	Present

No.	Items	Responsible	Deadline	Completed
1.	**Approval of Agenda** **The agenda was unanimously approved by all present members of the Academic Council**			
2.	**Approval of Previous Minutes of Meeting dated June 11, 2024**			

	The minutes was unanimously approved by all present members of the Academic Council			
3.	**Safety Moment** **<u>EHS Cultural Awareness</u>** ➢ To increase awareness of the safety culture amongst the community, the department has Integrated EHS in the planning stage of 80% of organized event. ➢ A CUD Public Health student has shown interest in observing our EHS Management system. This served as a great opportunity for the student to gain real world experience in managing safety. • The Dean of SPH stated that EHS will be integrated into the occupational safety courses in collaboration with the institutions Safety officer strengthening the connection between academic learning and practical application **<u>Government Regulatory visits</u>** ➢ Sallora Restaurant located in the Hub building was inspected by Dubai Municipality on November 9, 2024, for food and safety • They have passed the inspection. **<u>Feedback from a Person of Determination Student</u>** ➢ High Tables in the Hub building – the student is requesting lower height tables for easier access for wheelchair users. • The area has already been assessed and the lower height tables are ordered. ➢ Some classroom doors are difficult to open serving as a challenge to students that fall under the category of people of determination. • The doors have been accessed and the department is looking at either installing automatic doors or ensuring the handles are easy to operate for those with limited hand strength. ➢ Requesting easier access to elevators in the SOM building as currently they need security staff to escort the students due to non-accessibility of the door by the people of determination. • CUD is in discussions with Meeras to offer support on this.	Recorded		

	• The elevator in SOM is part of the common area of City Walk thus we are obligated to discuss this with Meeras to ensure it is POD friendly. **<u>Emergency Response Procedures</u>** The exit points closest to the Meeting room, MGT 106 were displayed to the present members of the academic council meeting. The exit point was identified as being just behind the SOM building, oppositive the Rolls Royce Showroom. **<u>Fire Drill</u>** As presented in the previous meeting that a scheduled fire drill was to be conducted towards the end of 2024. ➢ The meeting was already conducted with Dubai Civil Defense ➢ The fire drill will be unannounced to ensure the realistic feel.			
4.	**Curriculum Changes Approval – LNG 171 & LNG 172** Due to the unavailability of the Dean of First Year Student, Dr. Robert McClung (RM), this agenda items will be discussed in the next Academic Council Meeting.	Recorded		
5	**Finalizing the Implementation of Mandatory Internship Preparation Sessions (Follow up Item)** Due to the unavailability of the Career Services and Internship Coordinator, Ms. May ElKhoury (ME) and the Vice President of Student Affairs, Dr. Rami El Khatib (RK), this agenda item will be discussed in the next Academic Council Meeting.	Recorded		
6.	**Change in Incomplete grades policy – duration (Follow up Item)** The Dean of SOM presented the draft amendment of the incomplete grades policy in reference to the previous Academic Council Meeting.	Recorded	-	-

Incomplete Grade Policy

Suggested modifications to the Section on Incomplete Grade (I), Page 880 of the PPM 2024-25

Current Statement	Suggested Statement
Students whose course work is at a passing level but who for verifiable reasons beyond their control are unable to finish course work and have not obtained a passing grade by the end of a term (or the specified end of a course) may be granted a grade of "Incomplete" (I).	Students whose course work is at a passing level but who for verifiable reasons beyond their control are unable to finish course work and have not obtained a passing grade by the end of a term (or the specified end of a course) may be granted a grade of "Incomplete" (I).
Students may be granted up to twelve (12) calendar months after the scheduled end of the course to complete required additional work as determined by the Faculty/Instructor who assigned the "I" and to thereby qualify for a passing grade.	Students may be granted up to one semester (equivalent to 4 calendar months) after the scheduled end of the course to complete required additional work as determined by the Faculty/Instructor who assigned the "I" and to thereby qualify for a passing grade. An additional period of up to 4 months may be granted once with the approval of the Dean for extenuating reasons.

Action Item: The members of the council unanimously recommended to amend the last statement as follows:

MSH to prepare the amendments to be presented in the Senate meeting for approval.

	On an exceptional basis, a student may request a further extension of four (4) months subject to approval of the Dean. **The motion to approve the Incomplete grade policy with the above-mentioned amendment was moved by ME and seconded by IT.** **The motion to approve the incomplete grade policy with the above-mentioned amendment was unanimously approved by all present members of the academic council.**			
7	**ICT Application Management Policy** The new ICT Application Management Policy was presented to the members of the Academic Council **<u>ICT Application Management Policy</u>** **<u>Introduction</u>** The purpose of this policy is to establish framework for introducing and managing applications into the CUD application ecosystem without compromising confidentiality, integrity, availability and security of data and applications. This Policy promotes the following goals: • Ensure the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of CUD applications. • Ensure applications containing sensitive data are protected and compliant to regulatory authorities. • Prevent unauthorized access and data leaks. • Minimize risks to users and the University's reputation. • Align with strategic goal of operational excellence. **<u>Scope</u>** The Application Systems Management Policy applies to all applications used by CUD for work-related purposes whether hosted internally on CUD equipment or externally.	Recorded **AHK to correct the template for presentation in the Senate meeting for approval.**	-	-

	Action Item: It was advised by the Dean of IRP that ICT use the CUD standards template when presenting the policy **Motion to approve the ICT Application Management Policy was moved by AF and seconded by AMA.** **The motion to approve the ICT Application Management Policy was unanimously approved by all present academic council members.**			
8	**Proposal of LRC Database - Sciencedirect** A list of LRC databases were presented to the Deans to address their requirements to be budgeted for AY 2025-26. ***Action Item:*** The provost will present this in the Deans Council meeting with a final selection to be made and presented to the LRC department	Recorded **PS to add this agenda item into the Deans Council meeting**	-	-
9	**Converting the concentrations of BSc Public Health into Majors** The course syllabi for the current BSc Public Health Program with two (2) concentrations currently runs on thirty three (33) credits which is equivalent to converting concentrations to majors as per the requirement of the CAA. The dean of the school is requesting approval of the academic council to convert these concentrations into majors to be reflected in the degree as well as for enhancing recognition to each program separately for marketing purposes in attracting prospective students. The 1st draft of the substantive change document has been submitted to the IRP and an initial approval is requested for the Academic year 2025/26 pending approval of the CAA. **The motion to approve converting the two (2) concentrations in BSc Public Health into Majors was moved by AT and seconded by MI.** **The motion to approve converting the two (2) concentrations in BSc Public Health into Majors was unanimously approved by all present academic council members.**	Recorded	-	-

10.	**The tittle of UG degrees in the department of Psychology: changing from BA to BSc** Due to the unavailability of the Dean, Dr. Timothy Richard Jordan (TRJ), this agenda item will be discussed in the next Academic Council Meeting.	Recorded	-	-
11.	**Guidelines for Creative Works** During the reaccreditation of the Architecture and Interior Design program, the ERT requested the school to demonstrate assessment in creative works in the school. The first (1st) draft was submitted to the ERT, and their response has requested for further clarification in distinguishing academic research with creative scholarship contribution. ***The second (2nd) draft was presented to the academic council with motion to approve the same as requested by the CAA.*** ***Action Item:*** Creative Repository Section to be rephrased by stating the existing repository with the library. The mentioned Panel members need to be amended to include an equal number of those in the professional practice that can recognize and assess creative work. **The motion to approve the second (2) draft of Guidelines for Creative Works was moved by MI and seconded by AT.** **The motion to approve the second 92) draft of Guidelines for Creative Works was unanimously approved by all present members of the academic council**	Recorded **MI to make the necessary amendments for presentation in the senate meeting**	-	-
12	**Guidelines for Streaming Student Access to Studios and Computer Labs after 9:00PM** The CAA has requested a document to confirm and outline the institutions guidelines for students when accessing the studios and labs post 2100pm on campus. These guidelines must include safety concerns and procedures. ***The draft guidelines prepared by SAID were displayed to all academic council members.***	Recorded **MI, SM and AMA to draft the policy for presentation in the next academic**	-	-

	Feedback for actions items: ➢ The guidelines to include a section on incidents that may occur and protocols to follows ➢ These guidelines to be converted into a policy to apply. ➢ Given its relevance to the SEAST as well, both schools – SAID and SEAST are to work together to draft the final policy on these guidelines. ***Action Item:*** The draft policy is to be presented in the next academic council meeting.	**council meeting.**		
13	**New Process – Marcom Requests** Given the high demand of requests made to the Marcom office through different schools and departments in the institution, the marcom department has created a new request process. The new process requires all departments seeking marcom assistance to raise their requests through a comprehensive Microsoft jot form. This new process will ensure requests are made in a timely manner and ensures that all requests are streamlined. ***The draft request form was presented to the council members.*** ***Action items:*** *It was recommended that the marcom team shorten the form to stick to main requirements only. The final review is to be presented by the VPSA to the Provost which will then be presented in the dean's council meeting for further feedback before dissemination.*	Recorded **RK to present the final review to AF.**	-	-
14.	**Appointment of Honorary CUD Adjunct Faculty (Research)** **<u>Appointment of Adjunct Honorary Research Professors policy</u>** This policy is designed to address ➢ Productive researchers who wish to have a formal and professional affiliation with the Canadian University Dubai in an honorary position. ➢ A means by which interested productive researchers could affiliate their research paper authorship, research project investigator ship, and presentations with the Canadian University Dubai, in lieu of salary.	Recorded **AF to present the final policy in the next academic committee meeting.**	-	-

	➢ The honorary Adjunct Professors (Research) will advance CUD's research and innovation ranking and reputation for addressing UAE priority areas and fostering knowledge creation through international collaborative projects and publishing. Researchers hired against the said policy will be on a contractual non-financial agreement with the institution. ***The draft policy was presented to the academic council members*** ***Action Item:*** With the feedback received, the provost will make the minor amendments and inclusions into the policy to be presented in the next dean's council meeting.			
15.	**Any Other Business** **<u>Classroom Observations</u>** On behalf of the VPSA, the Registrar informed that council members that through a student disciplinary committee in referenced to the exam violations, it was stated that students were identified to attend classes they are not registered for, without the permission of the faculty. Emphasis was made on the importance of faculty awareness towards recognizing those registered students in their class. The importance of faculty attendance in class was stressed as these incidents may lead to critical factors if not supervised. ***Action Items:*** All deans to disseminate this information to all their faculty. **<u>New Program Accreditations</u>** It was announced that CUD has received the accreditation from the CAA for its two (2) new programs expected to start in Spring of AY 2024 – 25. ➢ MSc in Artificial Intelligence ➢ Master in Public Health	Recorded **All deans to emphasize the importance of this in their departmental meetings.**	-	-
16.	**<u>Adjournment of meeting</u>** The meeting was adjourned at 15:00 pm.			

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Academic Committee Meeting Minutes			
Thursday, February 27th, 2025,		**13:00 pm – 14:30 pm**	**CLASSROOM: MGT203**
CHAIRPERSON	Dr. Adam Lawrence Fenech (AF)	Chair & Provost	Present
ATTENDEES	Ms. Pari Shamsi (PS)	Executive Assistant to the Provost	Present
	Dr. Sherif Moussa (SM)	Dean, SEAST	Present
	Mr. Massimo Imparato (MI)	Dean, SAID	Present
	Dr. Aseel Takshe (AT)	Acting Dean, SHSP	Present
	Dr. Evangelos Moustakas (EM)	Dean, SCMS and SCI	Present
	Dr. Ibrahim Tabche (IT)	Acting Dean, SOM	Present
	Dr. Robert McClung (RM)	Dean – First Year Students	Present
	Dr. Yasir Faheem (YF)	Associate Professor and Program Coordinator of Cyber Security	Present
	Dr. Haytham El Messiry (HEM)	Associate Professor and Program Director of MSc AI	Present
	Dr. Tamer Mohamed Abdellatif Mohamed (TMAM)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of Cyber Security	Present
	Dr. Ahmed Al Gindy	Associate Professor and Program Coordinator of Electrical Engineering	Present
	Dr. Constantin Victor Spiridonidis (CVS)	Professor and Head of Dept, Architecture	Present
	Ms. Sophie Johnson (SJ)	Senior Lecturer and Head of Dept, Interior Design	Apologies
	Dr. Soumaya Askri (SA)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of Marketing & International Business	Present
	Dr. Mohammed Abdulhakim Nuruldeen (MAN)	Professor and Program Coordinator of E-Business and MITM	Present
	Dr. Osama Atayah (OA)	Associate Professor and Program Director of MBA	Present

	Dr. Ikhlaas Gurrib (IG)	Professor and Program Coordinator of Finance	Present
	Dr. Ossama Khassawneh (OK)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of HR and Caretaker of Entrepreneurship and Management	Present
	Mr. Mohammad Elmoshnib (ME)	Registrar	Present
	Dr. Anwar Abaidullah (AA)	Dean, IRP	Present
	Mrs. Menchie Armillo (MA)	Director, LRC	Present
	Mr. Aftab Khan (AK)	Director, ICT	Present
	Dr. Rami El Khattib (RK)	Vice President Student Services	Present
	Ms. Shaima Alhai (SA)	Student Council President/Vice President	Apologies
INVITEES	Mr. Junos Andrino (JA)	HSE/Facilities Officer	Apologies
	Ms. May El Khoury (MEK)	Career Services and Internship Coordinator	Present
	Dr. Saif Ur Rehman (SUR)	Associate Professor	Present
	Dr. Seif Khiati (SK)	Associate Professor	Present
	Dr. Rafik Belarbi (RB)	Visiting Professor and Researcher	Present
	Dr. Ammar Yahia (AY)	Visiting Professor and Research	Present

No.	Items	Responsible	Deadline	Completed
1.	**Approval of Agenda** **The agenda was unanimously approved by all present members of the Academic Council**			
2.	**Approval of Previous Minutes of Meeting dated February 6th, 2024**			

	The minutes were unanimously approved by all present members of the Academic Council			
3.	**Follow up item: Finalizing the implementation of Mandatory Internship Preparation Sessions** During a recent meeting the scope of the internship management system application was discussed. It was confirmed that students cannot register for internship unless and until the career services and internship coordinator confirms students have attended the mandatory preparation sessions through a checkbox.	Recorded	-	-
4.	**Follow up item: Policy for afterhours student access to studios and computer labs** This policy is not ready yet, thus as requested it will be presented in the next academic council meeting	MI	Next Academic Council Meeting	-
5	**Follow up item: Approval of new program, Master of Energy Efficiency and Sustainable Building** Following comments received in the last academic council meeting, the MEESB program was updated as follows: ➢ Study plan is updated to showcase dissertation as a standalone requirement in term 3. ➢ Energy Efficiency is embedded into the titles and addressed in the updated course descriptions. <u>Feedback from the council</u> ➢ Discrepancies were identified across forms wherein the study plan states dissertation, but the course description mentions thesis. ➢ Under course description, it states that the thesis can be supervised by the student's internship supervisor. Master student's do not have an internship thus this should be rectified accordingly • SK confirmed this would be amended to industry partner. ➢ Pre-requisites are not consistent amongst different documents, and this should be rectified and accurate.	AF	Senate Meeting, May 2025	-

	Motion to accept the approval of a new program in Master of Energy Efficiency and Sustainable Building was moved by IT and seconded by MAN **Six (6) members of the academic council moved to vote for the new program approval, while one (1) opposed and the remainder members abstained.** ***Action Items:*** *AF to present the program in the upcoming Senate meeting in May for approval.*			
6.	**Follow up item: Proposal for an SOM Journal (title confirmation)** Following the previous academic council meeting, a decision was yet to be made on the name of the journal. SUR proposed the three (3) below tittles with priority provided to title 1 and title 2: ➢ Title 1- Sustainable Business Review: Global Perspectives ➢ Title 2 – International Journal of Sustainable Business ➢ Title 3 – Global Journal of Sustainable Business Practices The council members were requested to vote between Title 1 and Title 2. ➢ Title 1 obtained 10 votes ➢ Title 2 obtained 12 votes. ***Action Items:*** *SUR was requested to proceed applying for the title International Journal of Sustainable Business*	SUR	-	-
7	**Follow up item: Approval of new program, BSc in Artificial Intelligence** As advised in the previous academic council meeting, the study plan was updated to include AI courses in Year one (1). The updated study plan was presented to the council members.	Recorded	-	-
8	**CAA Outcome based evaluation framework** Following the new CAA framework, processes have changed in certain functions as follows: <u>Accreditation of a new program</u> ➢ This is now swift and easy as program specifications are simplified. ➢ The CAA will review and assess the program until the 1st cohort graduates	Recorded	-	-

	<u>Maintaining program accreditation</u> ➢ Competition is higher as all universities, even those under KHDA, are now listed with the ministry. Based on the new framework there are fourteen (14) KPIs that the program is assessed against. ➢ The CAA will conduct a midterm review for all renewal of programs as part of the re-accreditation process. <u>OBF Model</u> ➢ Universities are evaluated on their performance against six (6) pillars each having a set of KPIs. ➢ A total of twenty four (24) KPIs are set for the university to be evaluated on. Executive Management is currently determining who is responsible against which KPI. The guide will be uploaded on SharePoint by the IRP department to be made accessible to all members			
9	**New Program Accreditation – CUD Internal Process** The new internal process for new programs as approved by the president was displayed to the council members. Timelines were included in some of the steps to ensure the workflow is processed in a timely manner. A total of nine (9) steps were identified wherein some will run parallel to each other. ➢ Step 1: The program should be approved by the school curriculum committee ➢ Step 2: IRP will prepare the feasibility report to be presented in the academic council by the provost for approval ➢ Step 3: If approved, proceed with comprehensive planning for student progression, faculty recruitment and laboratory resources ➢ Step 4: All administrative departments work in parallel to each other to submit their report on the following: • Strategic Marketing and Recruitment Planning • Facilities and Infrastructure Planning	Recorded	-	-

	• ICT Infrastructure and Resource Planning • Learning Resource Planning and Budgeting • Registration • First-Year Student Enrollment and Resource Planning • Corporate Training and Micro-Credential Development • Faculty Recruitment ➢ Step 5: Present the program to senior management for approval ➢ Step 6: If approved, present the program to the CFO for Financial Viability Report for the president's review and approval ➢ Step 7: If approved by the President, the program is to be presented in the senate meeting for further approval ➢ Step 8: If approved by the senate, the provost will present the program to the academic committee of the board of trustees. ➢ Step 9: if approved by the board of trustees, the application will be submitted to the CAA for accreditation.			
10.	**Study Plan Enhancements – BArch and BSc ID** The SAID has conducted a comparative analysis between the current study plan for the Bachelor of Arts in Architecture and the Bachelor of Science in Interior Design with a new study plan to be implemented following the recent trends and the ERT recommendations during the re-accreditation of the programs. The proposed changes are as follows: <u>Bachelor of Arts in Architecture</u> Removal of below courses from the study plan: ➢ Environmental Systems and Design Integration ➢ Structures 1 ➢ Advanced Environmental Systems and Design Integration ➢ Structures 2 Addition of the below courses as recommended by the CAA:	Recorded	-	-

	➢ Artificial Intelligence for Design Application in Year 3 ➢ Data analytics in the Built Environment in Year 3. <u>Bachelor of Science in Interior Design</u> Removal of below courses from the study plan: ➢ Construction and Desing Integration: Interior Design ➢ Environmental Systems and Design Integration ➢ Interior Finishes and Materials ➢ Lighting and Acoustics Addition of the below courses as recommended by the CAA: ➢ Artificial Intelligence for Design Application in Year 3 ➢ Data analytics in the Built Environment in Year 3.			
11.	**Admission Criteria Update – MSc AI** The admissions requirements to the MSc AI program are being modified to allow non computing and engineering graduates to register as well. The modifications are as follows: ➢ Applicants that don't posses the computing or engineering program requirements to register for this master can do so through remedial courses. • Applicants may be required to complete up to three (3) remedial courses to qualify for admissions. The courses are Programming for AI, Introduction to AI and Discrete Mathematics for Computer Science which will be determined by the school based on the applicant's CGPA. ➢ Panel Interview is required. • Admissions decision will be made by the panel consisting of one (1) SEAST Faculty, the program director and a representative from the registrar's office. **Motion to approve the admission criteria update for MSc AI is moved by AT and seconded by IT.** **The members of the academic council unanimously approved the admission criteria update for MSc AI.**	Recorded	-	-
12	**Minor of Study**	AMA	Next academic	-

	In SOM, there is a demand for students to graduate with a major and minor of study. Proposing a minor of study over and above the major is more competitive to the market. In the SOM, there are currently seven (7) BBA programs which allows any student to simply study five (5) major courses from any of the specialized BBA's and graduate with a minor of study. <u>Feedback from the council members</u> ➢ The CAA encourages double majors rather than a major and minor of study. • It was stated that the demand for double majors is always very low ➢ It was also recommended to check with the CAA if a minor of study can be mentioned in the degree given that it would only consist of five (5) courses. ***Action Items:*** *AMA to check with the CAA if a minor of study can be mentioned on the degree. Post the CAA response, the next step will be decided.*		council meeting	
13	**Distinguished Scholar Policy** AF presented a distinguished scholar policy, which is similar and covers what was presented in the honorary researcher policy and more. <u>Distinguished Scholar Policy</u> This policy is designed to address: • Recognizing distinguished members of academia, industry, and government who wish to affiliate themselves with the Canadian University Dubai in an honorary fashion. • A distinguished scholar is a prestigious role awarded to individuals recognized for their significant contributions to academia, research, government, industry, and/or community engagement. • The purpose of a distinguished scholar policy is to support the Canadian University Dubai in achieving its strategic goals through the recognition of excellence, enhancing institutional prestige, offering expertise and experience, providing mentorship and teaching, advancing research and scholarship, strengthening academic and professional networks, enhancing community outreach and fostering innovation and thought leadership.	AF	Senate Meeting, May 2025	-

	Motion to approve the distinguished fellow policy was moved by SM and seconded by MI **Motion to approve the distinguished fellow policy was unanimously approved by all present council members.** ***Action Items:*** *AF to present the policy in the Senate Meeting scheduled in May for approval to be presented to the BoT.*			
14.	**Approval of changes in MBA: Syllabus, Prerequisite and Cross Listed Courses** The graduate studies department sought approval on the three (3) curriculum changes they wish to implement. Changes are as follows: ➢ Syllabus changes • Textbooks were changed • Course assessments aligned with the best practice given the eight (8) cycle week for MBA • Course weekly outline was amended to align with the assigned textbook ➢ Pre-requisite Change • Removal of MBA 651 as a pre-requisite for some courses due to its irrelevance ➢ Cross-Listed courses • MBA is currently running against two (2) study plans of the old syllabus and the new syllabus thus, it is advised to cross list the common courses **Motion to approve the changes in the MBA syllabus, pre-requisite and cross listed courses was moved by IT and seconded by EM.** **Motion to approve the changes in the MBA syllabus, pre-requisite and cross listed courses was unanimously approved by all present council members**	Recorded	-	-
15.	**Any Other Business** <u>Lockers for SAID students</u> As advised by the ERT, SAID students need to have assigned lockers which are to be prioritized to first year students. In discussion with facilities, it was suggested that students would submit a	Recorded	-	-

	deposit of AED 200 which will be returned at the end of the AY upon receiving back the key and locker in good condition. MI sought suggestions on how to handle the collection of the deposit. ➢ The members advised MI to speak to Mr. Namsheed, Student accounts manager to discuss the collection process ➢ It was also advised to speak to legal on the possibility of students signing a form that stated the locker is the property of the institution and it reserves the right to enter the locker anytime deemed necessary thus, personal items should not be stored.			
16.	**Adjournment of meeting** The meeting was adjourned at 14:30 pm.			

CANADIAN UNIVERSITY DUBAI
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Academic Committee Meeting Minutes			
Wednesday, March 19th, 2025,		**11:00 am – 12:15 pm**	**CLASSROOM: MGT207**
CHAIRPERSON	Dr. Adam Lawrence Fenech (AF)	Chair & Provost	Present
ATTENDEES	Ms. Pari Shamsi (PS)	Executive Assistant to the Provost	Present
	Dr. Sherif Moussa (SM)	Dean, SEAST	Present
	Mr. Massimo Imparato (MI)	Dean, SAID	Present
	Dr. Aseel Takshe (AT)	Acting Dean, SHSP	Apologies
	Dr. Kiray Khoury (EM)	Head of Department, Communication	Apologies
	Dr. Ibrahim Tabche (IT)	Acting Dean, SOM	Present
	Dr. Robert McClung (RM)	Dean – First Year Students	Apologies
	Dr. Yasir Faheem (YF)	Associate Professor and Program Coordinator of Cyber Security	Present
	Dr. Haytham El Messiry (HEM)	Associate Professor and Program Director of MSc AI	Present
	Dr. Tamer Mohamed Abdellatif Mohamed (TMAM)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of Cyber Security	Present
	Dr. Constantin Victor Spiridonidis (CVS)	Professor and Head of Dept, Architecture	Present
	Ms. Sophie Johnson (SJ)	Senior Lecturer and Head of Dept, Interior Design	Present
	Dr. Soumaya Askri (SA)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of Marketing & International Business	Apologies
	Dr. Mohammed Abdulhakim Nuruldeen (MAN)	Professor and Program Coordinator of E-Business and MITM	Present
	Dr. Osama Atayah (OA)	Associate Professor and Program Director of MBA	Present
	Dr. Ikhlaas Gurrib (IG)	Professor and Program Coordinator of Finance	Apologies

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	Dr. Ossama Khassawneh (OK)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of HR and Caretaker of Entrepreneurship and Management	Apologies
	Mr. Mohammad Elmoshnib (ME)	Registrar	Present
	Dr. Anwar Abaidullah (AA)	Dean, IRP	Present
	Mrs. Menchie Armillo (MA)	Director, LRC	Present
	Mr. Aftab Khan (AK)	Director, ICT	Present
	Dr. Rami El Khattib (RK)	Vice President Student Services	Present
	Ms. Shaima Alhai (SA)	Student Council President/Vice President	Apologies
INVITEES	Mr. Junos Andrino (JA)	HSE/Facilities Officer	Apologies
	Dr. Rommel Sergio (RS)	Professor	Present

No.	Items	Responsible	Deadline	Completed
1.	**Approval of Agenda** **The agenda was unanimously approved by all present members of the Academic Council**			
2.	**Approval of Previous Minutes of Meeting dated February 27th, 2024** **The minutes were unanimously approved by all present members of the Academic Council**			
3.	**Safety Moment** This item was not covered as Council Member JA, was not able to attend the meeting.	Recorded	-	-
4.	**Follow up item: Policy for afterhours student access to studios and computer labs**	MI	Next Academic	-

	MI advised that internal meetings could not be conducted, and this policy will be ready for presentation in the next Academic Council Meeting.		Council Meeting	
5	**Follow up item: Minor of Study** Following the action item post the previous meeting, AMA sought confirmation from the CAA that the minor of study can be reflected in the student's degree upon graduation. ***Action Item:*** *Acting Dean of SOM, IT with the support of IRP to submit a substantive change application to the CAA to seek written approval to include a minor of study in its programs.*	IT and AMA		-
6.	**Dean's Honour List Policy** Dean of SOM, IT proposed a Dean's Honour List Policy to the council members for their feedback. <u>Policy Statement</u> The Dean's Honor List Award is designed to encourage and celebrate outstanding academic achievements among CUD students. This award acknowledges individual excellence and fosters a culture of academic rigor and dedication within CUD. The award reinforces the university's commitment to high-quality education and student success. ➢ A series of discussions rose around the criteria eligibility of student's full time enrollment status and minimum credit hours. ***Action Items:*** *Dean of SOM, IT was requested to meet with VPSA, RK to discuss the policy and prepare a draft for presentation in the next academic council meeting.*	IT	Next Academic Council Meeting	-
7	**Student Attendance and Absenteeism Policy** Post the dean's committee meeting, the current policy is updated to include the following: ➢ Undergraduate students are allowed a maximum of 25% absences of total course including both excused and unexcused absences.	AMA	Next Academic Council Meeting	-

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	➢ Graduate students are allowed a maximum of 35% absences of total course including both excused and unexcused absences. ➢ A section of exemptions was included. Exemptions are limited to academic, cultural, sports events or national service with the submission of supporting documents. ➢ Students arriving fifteen (15) minutes late and leaving fifteen (15) minutes early may be marked as absent at the discretion of the instructor. ➢ A section attendance recording was included to guide faculty members in ensuring attendance is recorded directly into CAMS. <u>Feedback from the council members included</u> ➢ The percentage of 25% is too low for an undergraduate studies student who may have a serious excusable absence ➢ Students that have an excusable absence should be treated differently and may be provided with provision to drop the course instead of receiving an F&A. ➢ Exemptions should also include serious illnesses, death in the family, any policy/court cases etc. ***Action Items:*** *Further discussions to be held in the next dean's committee meeting before a final policy is presented to the academic council for approval.*			
8	**Examination Quality Review and Moderation Policy Revision** Following the new CAA outcome-based framework, the EQRM policy was amended to include the ten (10) matrixes in the assessment rubrics for the quality of course delivery. The assessments forms have accordingly also been amended into one (1) form to reflect the same. ***Action Items:*** *AF requested that this form be brought back to the dean's committee meeting for further clarity before presentation in the academic council meeting.*	AMA	Next Academic Council Meeting	-
9	**Approval of Changes to Programs BScME and BScPREE** Post receiving CAA approval to change the Electrical Engineering program to Bachelor of Science in Mechatronics and receiving approval for the new program of Bachelor of Science in Power and	Recorded	-	-

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	Renewable Energy; the school found during the implementation stage with the registration that minor amendments needed to be made to the study plans of both programs. These amendments include: ➢ Changes of course code for some courses. ➢ Changes of pre-requisites for some courses as shown in the study plan. <u>Feedback</u> It was advised by a council member that MTH 012 (Pre-Calculus) should be removed as a pre-requisite because it is not part of the program's Study Plan and if required to be placed under admission criteria. **Motion to approve the minor amendments in the study plan for BScME and BScPREE along with the removal of MTH 012 (Pre-Calculus) as a pre-requisite was moved by MAN and seconded by OA.** **The Motion to approve the minor amendments in the study plan for BScME and BScPREE along with the removal of MTH 012 (Pre-Calculus as a pre-requisite was unanimously approved by all council members.**			
10.	**Faculty Office Hours Amendment** The faculty office hours are embedded into the Faculty and Professional Staff Role Policy under the duties and responsibilities of deans and faculty. To ensure clarity, the office hours are listed as follows: ➢ At least ONE (1) office hour per week per section must be held during the semester. These office hours must be posted and communicated to ensure accessibility and academic support.	AMA	To be presented in the next Senate Meeting	-

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	Motion to approve the amendment of faculty office hours within the faculty and professional staff role policy to include the requirement of number of hours per section was moved by SM and seconded by MI. **The motion to approve the amendment of faculty office hours within the faculty and professional staff role policy to include the requirement of number of hours per section was unanimously approved by all present council members.** ***Action Items:*** *To be presented by AMA in the Senate for approval prior to seeking BoT approval*			
11.	**Changes to MBA/MGT Curriculum of: MBA 649, MBA 661 and MGT 361** Three (3) SOM courses saw a change in their curriculum as follows: <u>MBA649</u> ➢ Tittle of Applied Research was amended to Group Project to avoid confusion with another course of the same name ➢ Added additional topics of Business Ethics Essentials ➢ Unified the rubrics for grading project, presentation and case study. **Motion to approve the amendments in the course MBA649 was moved by MA and seconded by TMAM.** **Motion to approve the amendments in the course MBA649 was unanimously approved by all present council members.** <u>MBA661</u> The council members were informed that this course is to be cross listed with MBA 679 due to 85.7% content alignment. <u>MGT361</u> The council members were informed that a new textbook was assigned to this course due to the unavailability of a new edition with the current textbook.	Recorded	-	-

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12	**Locker Assignment Policy** As recommended by the ERT during the recent re-accreditation visit for the school of Architecture that students must be assigned a locker. MI prepared a draft Locker Assignment Policy for the feedback of the academic council. This policy is generic to all students of CUD and not limited to SAID. <u>Policy Statement</u> Students assigned a locker must sign an **"Acknowledgment for Student Locker Assignment"** document, outlining the terms and conditions of use. The **Academic Support Officers** are responsible for managing the locker assignment process, ensuring proper allocation and maintenance. A **monetary deposit** will be required and held in the student's university account. Lockers are for individual use only and must be vacated at the end of the assignment period ***Action Item:*** *As this is a purely administrative policy, it was unanimously agreed that it should be presented in the senior management meeting to identify the responsible department as owners of the policy.*	AF	To be presented in the SM Meeting	-
15.	**Any Other Business**	Recorded	-	-
16.	**<u>Adjournment of meeting</u>** The meeting was adjourned at 12:15 pm.			

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CANADIAN UNIVERSITY DUBAI
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Academic Committee Meeting Minutes			
Thursday, April 24th, 2025		**13:00 pm – 14:41 pm**	**CLASSROOM: MGT208**
CHAIRPERSON	Dr. Adam Lawrence Fenech (AF)	Chair & Provost	Present
ATTENDEES	Ms. Pari Shamsi (PS)	Executive Assistant to the Provost	Present
	Dr. Sherif Moussa (SM)	Dean, SEAST	Present
	Mr. Massimo Imparato (MI)	Dean, SAID	Present
	Dr. Aseel Takshe (AT)	Acting Dean, SHSP	Present
	Dr. Kiray Khoury (EM)	Head of Department, Communication	Present
	Dr. Ibrahim Tabche (IT)	Acting Dean, SOM	Present
	Dr. Robert McClung (RM)	Dean – First Year Students	Present
	Dr. Yasir Faheem (YF)	Associate Professor and Program Coordinator of Cyber Security	Present
	Dr. Haytham El Messiry (HEM)	Associate Professor and Program Director of MSc AI	Present
	Dr. Tamer Mohamed Abdellatif Mohamed (TMAM)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of Cyber Security	Present
	Dr. Constantin Victor Spiridonidis (CVS)	Professor and Head of Dept, Architecture	Present
	Ms. Sophie Johnson (SJ)	Senior Lecturer and Head of Dept, Interior Design	Present
	Dr. Soumaya Askri (SA)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of Marketing & International Business	Present
	Dr. Mohammed Abdulhakim Nuruldeen (MAN)	Professor and Program Coordinator of E-Business and MITM	Present
	Dr. Osama Atayah (OA)	Associate Professor and Program Director of MBA	Apologies
	Dr. Ikhlaas Gurrib (IG)	Professor and Program Coordinator of Finance	Apologies

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	Dr. Ossama Khassawneh (OK)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of HR and Caretaker of Entrepreneurship and Management	Apologies
	Mr. Mohammad Elmoshnib (ME)	Registrar	Present
	Dr. Anwar Abaidullah (AA)	Dean, IRP	Present
	Mrs. Menchie Armillo (MA)	Director, LRC	Apologies
	Mr. Aftab Khan (AK)	Director, ICT	Present
	Dr. Rami El Khattib (RK)	Vice President Student Services	Present
	Ms. Shaima Alhai (SA)	Student Council President/Vice President	Apologies
INVITEES	Mr. Junos Andrino (JA)	HSE/Facilities Officer	Present
	Ms. Carolina Banayat	Senior Librarian	Present

No.	Items	Responsible	Deadline	Completed
1.	**Approval of Agenda** **The agenda was unanimously approved by all present members of the Academic Council**	-	-	-
2.	**Approval of Previous Minutes of Meeting dated March 19th, 2025** **The minutes were unanimously approved by all present members of the Academic Council**	-	-	-
3.	**Safety Moment** EHS Culture Awareness • Public Health students have contributed to the department by creating a campus risk assessment, which has become a valuable addition to CUD's re-accreditation portfolio. • Public Health students have completed Fire Safety Training.	Recorded	-	-

	• Plans are in place for Public Health students to conduct training sessions for CUD's third-party employees. • A refresher training session for fire wardens and first aiders will be scheduled soon. <u>Government Regulatory Visits</u> • The DHA conducted an inspection of the Health Center on April 21, 2025. Results are pending. <u>EHS Update</u> • The mock technical drill held on March 28, 2025, was successfully completed. • The Fire Alarm and Fire Fighting System were upgraded on March 21, 2025, enabling the scheduling of a DCD Evacuation Fire Drill. <u>Emergency Response Procedures</u> • For the committee members, the nearest exit point to classroom MGT208 has been displayed on screen, with the designated fire assembly point located just behind the CUD SOM building.			
4.	**Follow up item: Policy for after-hours student access to studios and computer labs** Following the discussions in the previous academic council meeting, the following amendments have been made to the Procedure section of the policy: **Procedure** Submission of Request Students must submit a formal request to the relevant faculty member and the Dean of the School. The request must include the following information: • Full names and student IDs of all students involved • Reason for the request • Date and time of the intended access • Venue(s) where the students plan to work	-	-	-

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	Approval Process
	
	The faculty and Dean will evaluate the request and may approve it under the following conditions:
	• Availability of a nurse on campus during the requested day and time
	• Adherence to equipment use restrictions, including:
	  ○ Unsupervised use of powered tools and equipment is strictly prohibited
	  ○ Use of chemicals is strictly prohibited
	
	Conditions of Access
	
	Approved access must be used strictly for academic purposes.
	Students must adhere to all university safety protocols and operational guidelines.
	The university reserves the right to revoke access if safety concerns arise or if students fail to comply with this policy.
	
	Motion to approve the After-Hours Student Access Policy was moved by IT and seconded by RM. The motion to approve the After-Hours Student Access Policy was unanimously approved by all present Academic Council Members.			

5	**Follow up item: Dean's Honour List Policy** Following the discussions in the previous academic council meeting, post the meeting between IT and RK, the following amendments have been made to the Criteria for the Award section of the policy: **Criteria for the Award** • To be considered for the Dean's Honor List Award, students must meet the following requirements: • Completion of a minimum of 30 credit hours (excluding Pass/Fail, transfer, and exempted courses). • Full-time enrolment status (minimum 12 credit hours/semester in the last two semesters) • A cumulative GPA (CGPA) of at least 3.80 • Clean disciplinary record (no official warnings) • No criminal convictions or pending charges **Motion to approve the Dean's Honour List Policy was moved by SM and seconded by SA.**	-	-	-

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	The motion to approve the Dean's Honour List Policy was unanimously approved by all present Academic Council Members.			
6.	**Follow up item: Student Attendance and Absenteeism Policy Revision** Following the discussions in the previous Academic Council meeting, the following changes have been made to the policy: ➢ Exceptions now include the death of immediate blood relatives, provided a death certificate is submitted within three (3) days. ➢ Student sick leave is now counted within the 25% limit of excused absences. **Action Items:** *As part of ongoing discussions regarding whether approved sick leaves should be categorized as excused absences, it was recommended to defer this agenda item. Final deliberation will take place once the Registrar provides a comprehensive report on all student absences due to sick leave.*	ME and AMA	Academic Council Meeting held in September 2025	-
7	**Follow up item: Examination Quality Review and Moderation Policy Revision** Following the request to present this policy at the Dean's Committee meeting prior to the Academic Council meeting, which was done on April 23, 2025, the policy is now being re-presented to the Academic Council for approval. The policy has been amended to merge the two (2) separate current forms into a single form that evaluates course files in accordance with the rubrics provided in the outcome-based framework. This new form will immediately replace the old form and will be used for the validation process by the External Review Team (ERT) of the CAA during any future re-accreditation audits. **Key Points for Academic Members:** ➢ All Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) must be linked to HR Faculty Performance. ➢ If a course does not have a rubric, an assessment marking scheme may be used instead.	-	-	-

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	Motion to approve the revised Examination Quality Review and Moderation Policy was moved by AT and seconded by SM. **The motion to approve the revised Examination Quality Review and Moderation Policy was unanimously approved by all present academic council members.**			
8	**GED Head Anatomy Sculpture** A new General Education (GED) course will be launched in the upcoming Fall semester, taught by Mr. Sylvain Tremblay. The course will follow a 2+2 = 3 format, comprising 2 Credit Hours for lectures and 2 Contact Hours for lab work. **Course Overview:** This course offers an in-depth introduction to head anatomy sculpture. It is designed to provide students with both the technical skills required to create their own anatomical sculptures and a comprehensive understanding of the key structural elements of the head, including: ➢ Cranial and facial bones ➢ Facial muscles ➢ Neck anatomy ➢ Skin structure **Additional Information:** ➢ **Course Fee:** AED 550 per student, per semester ➢ **Instruction Format:** Combination of theory and hands-on studio work **Motion to approve the new GED course called Head Anatomy Sculpture was moved by MI and seconded by IT.** **The motion to approve the new GED course called Head Anatomy Sculpture was unanimously approved by all present council members.**			-
9	**MTH199 Introduction to Statistics** A new 3-credit hour lecture-based course in Basic Statistics is being proposed, aimed at students who require foundational skills in statistics through a more concise and accessible course format	RM	-	-

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	Committee Feedback: ➢ The current textbook is business-focused and closely resembles material offered in an existing BBA course. It is recommended that a more general, non-specialized textbook be selected to better align the course with the General Education (GED) framework. ➢ The committee advised the inclusion of a practical component. This could be achieved either by adding a lab section or by incorporating practical sessions into selected lecture topics, potentially in the form of a 3-hour lab session. **Action Items:** *RM will revise the course proposal based on the committee's feedback and present an updated version at the next Academic Council meeting.*			
10.	**Canada Chair Policy** **Purpose:** This policy is designed to address • The appointment of Canada Chairs at the Canadian University Dubai as part of the CUD Canada Excellence program of research, a program providing research support to internationally leading scholars to accelerate ambitious research programs that align with strategic science, technology and innovation priorities of Dubai and the United Arab Emirates. • CUD Canada Chairs are prestigious awards given to outstanding scholars with distinguished records of research that have achieved significant honours and recognition as leaders in their field, both in Canada and internationally. **Motion to approve the Canada Chair Policy was moved by AT and seconded by IT.** **The motion to approve the Canada chair Policy was unanimously approved by all present academic council members.**	-	-	-

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11.	**Approve the syllabus modification for ENG420 – Internship** Approval was sought and granted to revise the grade assessment breakdown for the **ENG420 Internship** course as follows: ➢ **Academic Supervisor Evaluation Report** – 30% ➢ **Field Evaluation Report** – 50% This revised grading structure is aligned with the existing rubrics and syllabus and provides a more accurate reflection of student performance both academically and in the field. ➢ The approved amendments will be formally incorporated into the Study Plan. **Motion to approve the amended grade assessment breakdown for ENG420 – Internship course was moved by MI and seconded by IT.** **The motion to approve the amended grade assessment breakdown for ENG420 – Internship course was unanimously approved by all present academic council members.**	Recorded	-	-
12.	**Any Other Business** <u>Graduates List for AY 2024/25</u> The Registrar's Office will be emailing three (3) key graduates list to the Deans for their review: 1. **Confirmed Graduates – AY 2023/24:** A finalized list of students who were previously marked as potential graduates (pending completion of internships, summer courses, etc.) and are now confirmed to participate in the graduation ceremony. 2. **Actual Graduates – AY 2024/25:** A list of students who have officially graduated, including those from the Spring Cycle 1. 3. **Early Graduates (Walk-In Candidates):** Also referred to as "Walk-In" students, this list includes individuals expected to complete their requirements by Summer I, Summer II, or through the completion of an internship course. These students will be flagged as potential graduates.	Recorded ME and All Deans	-	-

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	CLO & PLO Policy Following the discussion in the Dean's Committee meeting, it was proposed to amend the formula for assessing individual student success. AMA has prepared a preliminary outline of the **Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)** and **Program Learning Outcomes (PLOs)** policy, which includes suggested thresholds for undergraduate, graduate, and doctorate-level courses. However, after several rounds of discussions, no consensus was reached regarding the proposed thresholds. Therefore, the policy is expected to undergo further analysis and will be presented again in the next meeting for final review and approval. SAID Electives To ensure that students enrolled under the previous **Architecture and Interior Design** study plan can benefit from the newly introduced courses in the updated curriculum, **MI is seeking a motion for approval** to allow these students to register for the new courses **as electives**. This measure aims to provide broader learning opportunities and ensure alignment with evolving industry standards without requiring a full transfer to the new study plan. **Motion to approve allowing students on the old study plan to register against the new courses as an elective was moved by SM and seconded by MAN.** **The motion to approve allowing students on the old study plan to register against the new courses as an elective was unanimously approved by all present academic council members**	AMA and All Deans		
13.	**Adjournment of meeting** The meeting was adjourned at 14:41 pm.			

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Academic Committee Meeting Minutes			
Thursday, June 19th, 2025		**13:00 pm – 14:30 pm**	**CLASSROOM: MGT101**
CHAIRPERSON	Dr. Adam Lawrence Fenech (AF)	Chair & Provost	Present
ATTENDEES	Ms. Pari Shamsi (PS)	Executive Assistant to the Provost	Present
	Dr. Sherif Moussa (SM)	Dean, SEAST	Present
	Mr. Massimo Imparato (MI)	Dean, SAID	Present
	Dr. Aseel Takshe (AT)	Acting Dean, SHSP	Present
	Dr. Kiray Khoury (EM)	Head of Department, Communication	Present
	Dr. Ibrahim Tabche (IT)	Acting Dean, SOM	Present
	Dr. Robert McClung (RM)	Dean – First Year Students	Present
	Dr. Yasir Faheem (YF)	Associate Professor and Program Coordinator of Cyber Security	Present
	Dr. Haytham El Messiry (HEM)	Associate Professor and Program Director of MSc AI	Present
	Dr. Tamer Mohamed Abdellatif Mohamed (TMAM)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of Cyber Security	Present
	Dr. Constantin Victor Spiridonidis (CVS)	Professor and Head of Dept, Architecture	Present
	Ms. Sophie Johnson (SJ)	Senior Lecturer and Head of Dept, Interior Design	Present
	Dr. Soumaya Askri (SA)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of Marketing & International Business	Present
	Dr. Mohammed Abdulhakim Nuruldeen (MAN)	Professor and Program Coordinator of E-Business and MITM	Present
	Dr. Osama Atayah (OA)	Associate Professor and Program Director of MBA	Present
	Dr. Ikhlaas Gurrib (IG)	Professor and Program Coordinator of Finance	Present

	Dr. Ossama Khassawneh (OK)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of HR and Caretaker of Entrepreneurship and Management	Apologies
	Mr. Mohammad Elmoshnib (ME)	Registrar	Present
	Dr. Anwar Abaidullah (AA)	Dean, IRP	Present
	Mrs. Menchie Armillo (MA)	Director, LRC	Present
	Mr. Aftab Khan (AK)	Director, ICT	Present
	Dr. Rami El Khattib (RK)	Vice President Student Services	Present
	Pr. Christopher Hill (CH)	Vice President, Research & Innovation	Present
	Ms. Shaima Alhai (SA)	Student Council President/Vice President	Apologies
INVITEES	Mr. Junos Andrino (JA)	HSE/Facilities Officer	Present

No.	Items	Responsible	Deadline	Completed
1.	**Approval of Agenda** The agenda was approved with the below additional added items: 16. Waiving of Math Placement Test for Interior Design Program 17. Grade Submission Deadline **The agenda was unanimously approved with the above additions by all present members of the Academic Council**	-	-	-
2.	**Approval of Previous Minutes of Meeting dated April 24th, 2025** **The minutes were unanimously approved by all present members of the Academic Council**	-	-	-

3.	**Safety Moment** ➢ There were no firefighting maintenance activities or scheduled fire drills on the day of the meeting ➢ A civil defense visit is scheduled for tomorrow, June 20th, 2025. • Members are requested to leave the premises by maximum 20:00pm. ➢ The facilities department's next project is converting the main doors into an automatic sliding door to also accommodate students of determination. • This is yet to be approved by senior management. ➢ The nearest fire exit is by the reception area of SOM building with the assembly point being the open area along happiness street (behind CUD Café). **<u>Feedback from the council</u>** ❖ A policy was signed and approved by the BoT to conduct all renovations in a sustainable manner, thus recommending a revolving door as opposed to a sliding door which would allow the air to remain inside the building. ○ The safety officer suggested proposing an air curtain in addition to the sliding door proposal to prevent cool air escaping the building hence supporting both accessibility and energy efficiency.	Recorded	-	-
4.	**Newly Proposed Program Structure – BSc in Design and Artificial Intelligence** SAID proposed a new interdisciplinary program between Design and Artificial Intelligence enabling graduates to use AI as a design collaborator to encourage new creative, interactive and digital ideas. The Dean presented the Program Learning outcomes and program study plan to the members of the academic council for their feedback. **<u>Feedback from the council</u>** ❖ The link between Design and AI is missing in the study plan and further adjustments are necessary to highlight the connection.	MI	-	-

	○ Students are expected to graduate as designers; however the study plan offers mor AI courses. ❖ As per the ministry, thirty (30) credit hours equivalent to ten (10) unique specialized courses must be offered. The displayed study plan displays only six (6); four (4) more unique courses must be offered. ❖ The PLOs listed are too many which need to be aligned with the CLOs. **The motion to proceed with the next steps of submission to IRP post implementation of recommendations was moved by AT and seconded by RM.** **The motion to proceed with the next steps of submission to IRP post implementation of recommendations was unanimously approved by all present members of the council.**			
5	**Proposed changes to MTH195 Syllabus** Following recommendations and comments from the previous academic council meeting, this agenda it being presented again with the following proposed changes: ➢ Course name change to **Introduction to Statistics** ➢ Course structure reverting to a 2-2-3 consisting of a lecture and lab component ➢ As the previous textbook was business focused a new Textbook is suggested reflecting the new course syllabus. The Dean of first year students presented the updated course syllabus to the members of the council for their review and feedback. **Motion to approve the proposed changes to the MTH195 Syllabus was moved by MI and seconded by HEM.** **The motion to approve the proposed changes to the MTH195 Syllabus was unanimously approved by all present members of the council.**	Recorded	-	-
6.	**New Data Literacy Course** This is a newly proposed University course designed by CUD's Registrar to be offered as an elective to all students aligned with the UAE Vision 2031.	Recorded	-	-

	This course is an introductory, multidisciplinary university course designed to help students from all fields navigate and thrive in today's data-driven world. Rooted in STEM principles and digital fluency, it empowers learners to understand, analyze, and communicate data with clarity and confidence. The course structure is 2-2-3 consisting of a lecture and lab component. The lab component covers the use of excel and Power BI. Framed around four (4) levels of analytics: descriptive, diagnostic, predictive and prescriptive. The Dean of first year students presented the course syllabus to the members of the council for their review and feedback. **<u>Feedback from the council</u>** ❖ The course description needs to be shortened. ❖ The CLOs are of a higher level and should be lowered to reflect the introductory level. **The motion to approve the new Data Literacy Course with the recommended changes was moved by CH and seconded by IT.** **The motion to approve the new Data Literacy Course with the recommended changes was unanimously approved by all present members of the council.**			
7	**Merging Entrepreneurship Courses** The Dean of SOM proposed amending the course structure into 2-1-2-1 consisting of only a lecture component based on the below key factors: ➢ Benchmarking with UAE Universities ➢ Structural Redundancy and Learning Efficiency • The current structure has overlapping topics, duplicated assessments across four projects, straining students without adding clear value. ➢ Students Feedback	Recorded	-	-

	• Students often deprioritize 1-credit lab components (ENT142/242) as their lower weight has limited GPA impact. This has affected learning seriousness and overall engagement. ➢ Improved Student Engagement and Continuity • A two-course model would allow students to deepen their initial entrepreneurial ideas across semesters with the same group, fostering continuity and more meaningful project development. It also minimizes gaps in learning caused by course discontinuity across semesters. ➢ Increased Efficiency in course scheduling, classroom and staff allocation. **The motion to approve the new structure of Entrepreneurship courses was moved by RM and seconded by MI.** **The motion to approve the new structure of Entrepreneurship courses was unanimously approved by all present members of the council.**			
8	**Proposal – Conversion of QBA Labs to Tutorials** This agenda item is deferred for further discussions as recorded in the recently held Dean's committee meeting.	IT	TBD	-
9	**Internship Policy** The internship process for SOM students is sixteen (16) weeks. If a student were to start their internship in June, post the spring semester they would be expected to complete their internship by mid-September. This delays the student from pursuing a Master degree as they would have faced a delay in receiving their Bachelor degree. The school seeks approval to propose to students the option of completing their internship in one go or splitting it into two (2) eight (8) weeks of internship over two (2) years. The school raises this issue and requests a meeting with management to discuss this further **<u>Feedback from the council</u>** ❖ This is already approved as per the ministry guidelines applicable to all schools, thus, no approval is required.	Recorded	-	-

10.	**Removal of SOM Pre-requisite courses** <u>SCM310 – Supply Chain Management</u> As per the current syllabi, this course has two (2) pre-requisites which are MGT361 Operations Management and MGT301 Introduction to Business analytics. MGT301 has no correlation with SCM310 thus it is proposed to only offer MGT361 as a pre-requisite given its relevance. <u>MGT220 Organizational Behaviour</u> As per the current syllabi, this course has one (1) pre-requisite which is HRM210 Human Resource Management. As the content of HRM210 is not relevant to MGT220, it is proposed to remove this pre-requisite entirely. **<u>Feedback from the council</u>** ❖ It was also recommended by the ERT to remove the pre-requisites as suggested. ❖ As per the norm, OB courses are normally offered as a pre-requisite to HR courses. **The motion to approve the removal of SOM Pre-requisite courses was moved by RM and seconded by CH.** **The motion to approve the removal of SOM Pre-requisite courses was unanimously approved by all present members of the council.**	Recorded	-	-
11.	**RTA315 New Textbook** The library was unable to order the current assigned textbook to the course RTA315 thus, research was conducted to find an alternative. Approval is sought to proceed with offering the textbook called **Fundamentals of Business 4th Edition. Virginia Tech Publications** by R. Poff.	Recorded	-	-

	This book supports Creative Industries and gives knowledge in Business specifically in areas of Entrepreneurship, finance and Management. **The motion to approve the new textbook for the course RTA315 was moved by IT and seconded by AT. The motion to approve the new textbook for the course RTA315 was unanimously approved by all present members of the council.**			
12.	**Addition of Lab Component in BSc in Cyber Security** The SEAST is proposing to amend the course structure of CYS311, 411 and 414 to a 2-2-3 consisting of lecture and lab components to align with best pedagogical practices and evolving industry requirements effective academic year 2025-26. The decision for structure change was based on: ➢ Student Feedback ➢ Exit Surveys ➢ Best practices within the cyber security programs through benchmarking. A motion is sought to proceed with changing the structure effective AY 2025-26 and to start developing the new syllabus. **<u>Feedback from the council</u>** As one (1) of the three (3) courses will be offered in Fall, it is advisable to check beforehand the available resources for lab utilization. As SEAST already has Lab Instructors amongst its faculty, it is financially more resourceful to include the lab components mentioned in the course. This may result in the need to build more labs in the campus which will require further involvement and discussion of management due to its financial implications. **The motion to approve the course structure for CYS 311, 411 and 414 and to start working on the new syllabus was moved by MI and seconded by RM.** **The motion to approve the course structure for CYS 311, 411 and 414 and to start working on the new syllabus was unanimously approved by all present members of the council.**	Recorded	-	-

	For Information, the SEAST updated council members on the update of weekly topics for some courses taking into consideration the key points of: ➢ Data Privacy and Security Considerations ➢ Local and Global Impact of the Computing Solution This includes the following additions into the below mentioned courses: ➢ BCS303 – Inclusion of Privacy ➢ BCS401 – Inclusion of Privacy and Security of Information Systems ➢ BCS410 – adding two (2) sections into the final report of the capstone project to analyze the two (2) mentioned key points.			
13.	**Advising Workflow Annex A of Submitted Document** The SEAST process of advising was created in a visual workflow format and displayed to council members for input and support towards other schools. **<u>Recommendation of the Council Members</u>** ❖ As the workflow was created from the academic advising policy and is applicable to all schools it was recommended to include the workflow into the academic advising policy. **The motion to include the Workflow Annex A into the academic advising policy was moved by IT and seconded by MAN.** **The motion to include the Workflow Annex A into the academic advising policy was unanimously approved by all present members of the council.**	TMAM	-	-
14.	**APA PsychArticles – Subscription Proposal** This item it to be deferred till the Dean of Psychology is hired.	MA	-	-
15.	**Course Resource Usage Report 2024** The course textbook usage report presented by the LRC. Currently three (3) copies of each textbook is purchased as instructed by the former VPAA to reduce from five (5) copies given the low number of usages by students.	MA	-	-

	As the usage numbers are still low, the LRC sought further guidance if they should proceed with purchasing three (3) copies of each textbook. **<u>Recommendation of the council</u>** ❖ Two (2) copies only should be purchased – one (1) for faculty and one (1) for students to be lent out on rotational basis. ○ Should a demand be identified, the LRC will be granted authority to purchase more copies. **<u>A detailed list of course textbooks utilization to be submitted by the LRC director to allow for an informed decision on volume of purchase</u>** **<u>Accordingly, motion will be presented to the budget committee.</u>**			
16.	**Waiving of Math Placement Test for Interior Design Program** In the current study plan, students need to take a math placement test as a pre-requisite to register for the MTH195 course offered in the ID program. It was discussed in the Dean's committee meeting to waive the math placement test and incorporate with the vision of the new syllabus the MTH195 course wherein students learn to obtain math literacy skills within the course and not prior. **The motion to remove the Math Placement as a pre-requisite for MTH195 was moved by HEM and seconded by CH.** **The motion to remove the Math Placement as a pre-requisite for MTH195 was unanimously approved by all present council members.**			
17.	**Grade Submission Deadline** The registrar reminded all academics and deans of the need to submit grades post midterm exams within seventy-two (72) hours as per the policy. It was requested that Deans inform all faculty in their schools of this reminder. ➢ The provost stressed the importance of grade submission within the required timeframe.	Recorded	-	-

18.	**Adjournment of meeting** The meeting was adjourned at 14:30 pm.			

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Academic Committee Meeting Minutes			
Thursday, November 6th, 2025		**18:00 pm – 22:00 pm**	**MGT AUDITORIUM**
CHAIRPERSON	Dr. Karim Chelli (KC)	Chair, President and Vice - Chancellor	Present
ATTENDEES	Dr. Adam Lawrence Fenech (AF)	Provost	Present
	Ms. Pari Shamsi (PS)	Executive Assistant to the Provost	Present
	Dr. Sherif Moussa (SM)	Dean, SEAST	Present
	Mr. Massimo Imparato (MI)	Dean, SAID	Present
	Dr. Aseel Takshe (AT)	Acting Dean, SHSP	Present
	Dr. Kiray Khoury (EM)	Head of Department, Communication	Apologies
	Dr. Ibrahim Tabche (IT)	Acting Dean, SOM	Present
	Dr. Robert McClung (RM)	Dean – First Year Students	Present
	Dr. Yasir Faheem (YF)	Associate Professor and Program Coordinator of Cyber Security	Present
	Dr. Haytham El Messiry (HEM)	Associate Professor and Program Director of MSc AI	Apologies
	Dr. Tamer Mohamed Abdellatif Mohamed (TMAM)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of Cyber Security	Present
	Dr. Constantin Victor Spiridonidis (CVS)	Professor and Head of Dept, Architecture	Apologies
	Ms. Sophie Johnson (SJ)	Senior Lecturer and Head of Dept, Interior Design	Apologies
	Dr. Soumaya Askri (SA)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of Marketing & International Business	Present
	Dr. Mohammed Abdulhakim Nuruldeen (MAN)	Professor and Program Coordinator of E-Business and MITM	Apologies
	Dr. Osama Atayah (OA)	Associate Professor and Program Director of MBA	Present

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	Dr. Ikhlaas Gurrib (IG)	Professor and Program Coordinator of Finance	Apologies
	Dr. Ossama Khassawneh (OK)	Assistant Professor and Program Coordinator of HR and Caretaker of Entrepreneurship and Management	Apologies
	Mr. Mohammad Elmoshnib (ME)	Registrar	Present
	Dr. Anwar Abaidullah (AA)	Dean, IRP	Present
	Mrs. Menchie Armillo (MA)	Director, LRC	Present
	Mr. Aftab Khan (AK)	Director, ICT	Apologies
	Dr. Rami El Khatib (RK)	Vice President Student Services	Present
	Pr. Christopher Hill (CH)	Vice President, Research & Innovation	Apologies
	Ms. Shaima Alhai (SA)	Student Council President/Vice President	Apologies

No.	Items	Responsible	Deadline	Completed
1.	**Approval of Agenda** **The motion to approve the agenda was moved by AF and seconded by IT**	-	-	-
2.	**Approval of Previous Minutes of Meeting dated June 19th, 2025** **The motion to approve the minutes was moved by SM and seconded by MA**	-	-	-
3.	**SOM – New Program Proposals** The SOM Dean presented draft proposals for new programs.			-

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	<u>Minor of Study in Business for non-Business students</u> The school proposed launching a minor of business to students enrolled in other non-business programs. This program would include foundation business courses to provide students with a business acumen sense that could help boost their careers. Proposed courses are already available and offered in the university in every semester with available manpower. <u>Minor of Study for Business students</u> The school proposed offering a minor of study for students enrolled in the business program to enhance graduate competitiveness. A substantive change application would need to be submitted to the CAA with the study plan outline which is to include an extra fifteen (15) credit hours to graduate. **<u>Feedback from the council</u>** ❖ A minor study promoted for non-business students will not sell thus it is more attractive to promote a generic minor of study in business to all students. ❖ SOM were advised to re-name the title to minor of study in business administration and seek CAA approval through the Substantive Change Application ❖ Re-review the courses to replace with courses that have more substance ❖ Suggested offering minor courses in Accounting, Finance or even Project Management that can also attract micro-credential courses. ❖ The registrar is advised to check admission requirements for students at other universities who wish to study a minor in Business Administration with CUD. **The motion to approve the draft proposal of Minor of Study in Business Administration was moved by IT and seconded by SM.** **The motion to approve the draft proposal of Minor of Study in Business Administration was unanimously approved by all present members of the academic council.**	**IT to re-review the courses AND ME to check Admission Requirements**	**December 2026** **December 2026**	
	<u>Bachelor of Business Analytics and AI</u> This program is proposed for launch in Fall 2026. It is designed to prepare students for careers in data-driven business decisions, integrating analytics, AI, statistics and business intelligence.	**IT to revise the program**	**December 2026**	

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	Program objectives and curriculum were presented to the members of the council. **Feedback from the council** ❖ Further research and prepping are required as AI courses provided are not substantial to include AI in the program title. ❖ The school is advised to review the university course of AI and the Engineering AI program to seek course offerings as links where applicable to avoid creating overlap and duplication. **Motion to approve the initial draft of introducing a Bachelor of Business Analytics and AI was moved by IT and seconded by SM.** **The motion to approve the initial draft of introducing a Bachelor of Business Analytics and AI was unanimously approved by all present members of the council.** Two (2) programs **proposals** were proposed for the Graduate School in line with the UAE vision and strategy along with the institution's strategic plan. Master of Science in Artificial Intelligence in Business This program is not a technical programming degree but rather focuses on strategic decision making, process optimization and responsible AI adoption to help business leaders learn to apply AI to improve organization performance. *The program overview, competency goals and curriculum structure was presented to the members of the council **Feedback from the Council** ❖ Further research needs to be conducted with experts to advise further as this isn't a technical program, ❖ The proposed courses need to have more AI related course offerings ❖ The program name should change to display relevant to the course content and program overview. ❖ The school cannot offer a Master in Science degree where there are no Science programs offered at the UG level. ❖ SOM were advised to revise the program and its tittle for presentation in the next meeting	**IT to revise the program courses and title**	**December 2026**	

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	Motion to approve the draft proposal to introduce a Master related to AI in the School of Management was moved by OK and seconded by AF **The motion to approve the draft proposal to introduce a Master related to AI in the School of Management was unanimously approved by all present members of the academic council** <u>Master of Science in FinTech</u> The program is to prepare professionals to lead innovations in digital finance. The program overview, goals and curriculum structure was presented to the council members. **<u>Feedback from the Council</u>** ❖ This is a solid proposal, and emphasis is made on hiring the right experts in the program ❖ It is instructed to add as an outcome that the program offers 70% credit of the CMA Professional Certification that will be marketed as the program's unique selling point. ❖ The title is to be renamed with suggested proposals to include innovation, entrepreneurship or digital innovation/transformation to fit the institutions' strategic plan and vision of the UAE. ❖ The program should include startups as a journey of the program and not an outcome. **Motion to approve the draft proposal to introduce a Master related to FinTech in the School of Management was moved by IT and seconded by KC.** **The motion to approve the draft proposal to introduce a Master related to FinTech in the School of Management was unanimously approved by all present members of the academic council.**	**IT to revise the program title**	**December 2026**	
4.	**SAID – Co-Op Education** SAID wishes to introduce a (co-op) Co-operative education system which is a structured educational program that integrates a student's academic studies with relevant, paid and practical work experience. A draft of what the Co-op Education semester study plan would like was presented to the council members. This study plan shows the integration of Internship within semester eight (8) of the program and not in the final year	**MI to revise and update the program**	**December 2026**	-

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	Feedback from the Council ❖ In Canada, a co-op program is privileged to those students who qualify to register thus it is not made available to all students registered in a regular program. That said, a co-op program and a regular program should be running simultaneously. ❖ A co-op program includes an additional six (6) semester to the regular eight (8) semester program, therefore adding another year of study. ❖ An expert in Canada will need to be hired to support the set up of a co-op program **MI to update and present this item in the next meeting* **Motion to approve the initial idea of introducing a co-op education in the School of Architecture and Interior Design was moved by MI and seconded by KC.** **The motion to approve the initial idea of introducing a co-op education in the School of Architecture and Interior Design was unanimously approved by all present members of the academic council.**			
5	**Lecturer Workload – Propose to Amend for Master holder** The Dean of SOM proposed the workload of fifteen (15) credit hours in an academic semester for a Master holder which would lead to a more resourceful schedule and planning of course offerings. **Feedback from the council** It was reminded that the workload of a lecturer has always been fifteen (15) credit hours as per the CUD policy which has not changed since. All deans were advised to implement the policy as per the faculty workload distribution available in the CUD P&P Manual.	Recorded	-	-
6.	**University Courses– Proposal to amend ENT 242, 2 practical courses** Approval was sought to make small amendments in the syllabus of ENT 242 to convert it into a practical course rather than paper based. Quiz is to be removed, and Risk Mitigation is to be included allowing students the opportunity to be better trained to present their ideas and turn them into reality	Recorded	-	-

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	Motion to approve the amendments to the course syllabus for ENT 242 was moved by RM and seconded by AT. **The motion to approve the amendments to the course syllabus for ENT 242 was unanimously approved by all present member of the academic council.**			
7	**GED Courses - Music, Fine Arts and Design** In addition to Music and Sculpture, CUD will launch new courses in Fine Arts, Design and Graphic Design with a studio element to better serve the market trends and need of the community. As Music is also an industry, it is imperative that CUD grows its music program. **Motion to approve the proposal of offering Fine Arts and Graphic Design GED courses and offer a Music program was moved by KC and seconded by RM.** **The motion to approve the proposal of offering Fine Arts and Graphic Design GED courses and offer a Music program was unanimously approved by all present members of the academic committee.**	Recorded	-	-
8	**University Courses - Sustainability** Members of the academic council were informed that the Board of Trustees approved the launch of a university course of Sustainability in line with the ranking SDGs that serve the UAE vision and the institutions strategic plan. The course is currently under development and will be presented to the council once prepared.	Recorded	-	-
9	**Communication Studios** The Communications and Creative Industries programs need to be enhanced to incorporate the use of studios. These studios will then be monitored and a full report on the activities within the respective programs will be presented to the board in the Spring meeting of 2026.	Recorded	-	-
10.	**Incubator** All deans were reminded that Incubator should be included as a student Journey in every program at the university. All PLOs must lead to incubator as an outcome and the faculty must prepare students as future business leaders.	Recorded	-	-

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11.	**Foundation Program** As part of strategic competitiveness, it was instructed to build a foundation program that caters to those high school students who do not finish their A levels and prefer to spend that year in university. It was identified that a competitive university accepts many student intakes each year on their foundation program and CUD should investigate this market.	Recorded	-	-
18.	**Adjournment of meeting** The meeting was adjourned at 22:00 pm.			

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